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CHENNAI, IDHU UNGALUKKANA REVOLUTION



Today...
Lives have tightened.
Homes have shrunk into pigeonholes.
Between concrete, traffic and pollution
peace slipped away.
The city kept expanding.
But our lives kept shrinking.
Less laughter. Less play. Less living.

But what if...
Space came back?
Green found its way home?
Children had room to run again?
And families... had time to just be?

This isn't just an upgrade.
This is reclaiming what the city took away.
This is a revolution where life expands again.

THIS IS CASAGRAND HIGHCITY ON ORR

LAUNCHING

CASAGRANDBANG ON ORR

HIGHCITY

LUXURIOUS 2 & 3 BHK APTS. FROM JUST ₹49L - ₹67L*
[THIS PRICE IS FOR FIRST 25 BOOKINGS ONLY]



MASTER CRAFTED BY A GLOBAL VISIONARY

- 41-acre mega township
- Designed by Mr. Wong Chiu Man (WOW Architects, Singapore)
- Unfolding into 22-floor towers and 4,000+ homes



WHERE LIFE IS RULED BY NATURE

- 28 acres of open space
- 22-acre lush greenery that includes 10-acre nature zones
- One-of-a-kind 3.5-acre tropical forest



EXPANSIVE HOMES THAT MAKE A STATEMENT

- 73% carpet area efficiency & uninterrupted scenic views
- Convertible balconies with 3x light & ventilation
- American designed CP & sanitary fittings



THE APEX OF BLISS & LEISURE

- 163 world-class amenities with 25+ exclusive for kids
- 21,000 sft. resort-style aquatic paradise with 3 swimming pools including an olympic-size
- Lavish 1.3-acre recreational clubhouse



A FULFILLING ECOSYSTEM

- Casagrand International School within the community
- Co-working spaces, EV charging, car wash bay & more
- Casagrand curated community events, festivals and social experiences



SPORTING AMBITION TAKES ROOT & RISES

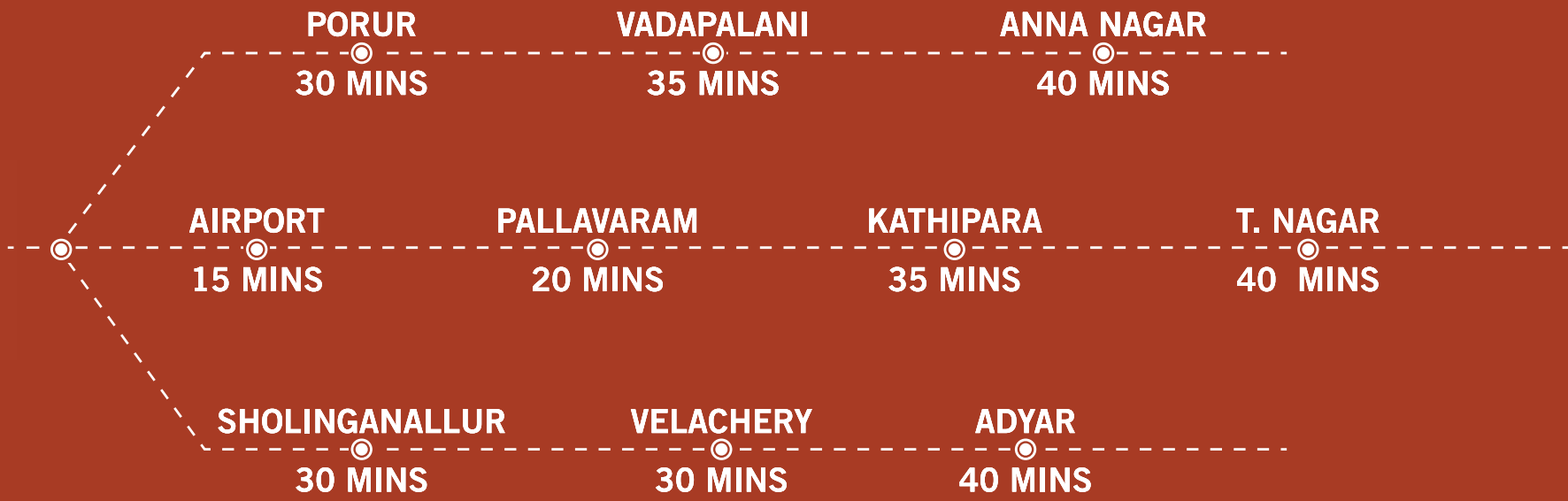
- India's largest 5-acre sports clubhouse
- 35+ sports courts built to global standards
- Lifetime premium membership for residents

CASAGRANDBANG ON ORR



THE REVOLUTIONARY LOCATION

THE ONLY PLACE CONNECTED TO ANNA NAGAR, T. NAGAR & ADYAR WITHIN 40 MINS



THE REVOLUTIONARY PRICE

PRICED BEST AMONG THE NEIGHBOURHOODS

TAMBARAM MARKET PRICE ₹7000/SFT.	PALLAVARAM MARKET PRICE ₹8000/SFT.	PORUR MARKET PRICE ₹9000/SFT.	VELACHERY MARKET PRICE ₹10000/SFT.
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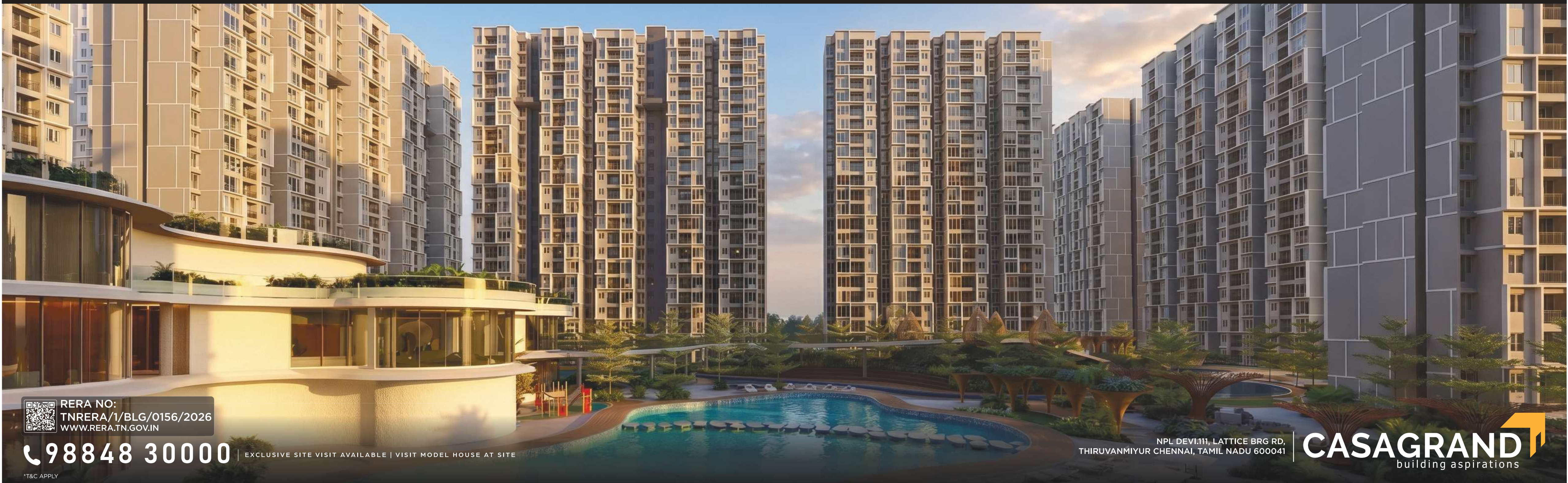
HIGHCITY LAUNCH PRICE ₹3899/SFT.	EARLY BIRD PRICE ₹3699/SFT. (FIRST 25 BOOKINGS)	₹3799/SFT. (26 - 50 BOOKINGS)	₹3899/SFT. (51 - 100 BOOKINGS)
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3 BHK	1284 - 1636 SFT.	₹57L - ₹70L	₹55L - ₹67L

PHASE-I TOTAL UNITS: 1099 | SOLD: 329 | AVAILABLE: 770

HANDOVER IN 36 MONTHS



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*T&C APPLY

NPL-DEVI-111, LATTICE BRG RD,
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CASAGRANDBANG ON ORR
building aspirations

LAUNCHING

CASAGRANDBANG ON ORR

HIGHCITY

LUXURIOUS 2 & 3 BHK APTS. FROM JUST ₹49L - ₹67L*



SWIMMING POOL

ENTERTAINMENT & FEATURES

- SPORTS**

Cricket practice net, multipurpose court, half basketball court, pickle ball court, badminton court, woodland fitness, fitness recharge pod & active loop
- KIDS**

Rock climbing wall, toddler play area, Little pine play arena, sunbeam pavilion, hidden wonderland, adventure play lawn play pavilion, hilltop play zone & more...
- SWIMMING POOL**

Adult swimming pool (25m lap), kid's splash pool, kid's shallow play pool, jacuzzi leisure pool, lazy pool, dancing waters, island cabana, poolside meditation deck, poolside patio, in-water loungers, aqua trail & more...
- ENTERTAINMENT**

Sunken lawn, lantern court with BBQ pods, party pavilion, makers' market, the pop-up plaza & riverside nook
- FEATURES**

Multipurpose lawn, bus bay with halt zone, drop off plaza, elevated family deck, sky nest, treetop walk, senior citizen alcove, mirror pool, water feature with boulders & more...
- THEMED GARDENS**

Foliage court, community gardens, fragrant grove, woodland meadows, herb, spice & edible garden

163
REVOLUTIONARY
AMENITIES

CLUBHOUSE AMENITIES

- ENTERTAINMENT & CONVENIENCE**

Central atrium with seating, double height banquet hall, serene lounge, multipurpose hall, mini theatre, learning centre, reading pods, scholar's lounge, reading nook, business centre & more...
- KIDS PLAY AREA & CRECHE**

Rainbow ball pool, soft fall mounds, explorers toy wall, cribs, mini trampoline, pause & play court, little artists' corner, magnetic dart board, mini basketball hoop, velcro wall, little builders' zone & more...
- INDOOR GAMES ROOM**

Video gaming console, air hockey, foosball, snooker, table tennis, VR duo & subsoccer tablet
- FEATURES & FACILITIES**

Convenience store, FMS room & association room, guest room, car washing bay & car charging bays
- ROOFTOP**

Sky deck, skyline café, zen terrace, vista seater & pebble lounge
- & 50+ IN THE SPORTS CLUB**
- 

SCAN TO EXPERIENCE
VIRTUAL WALKTHROUGH



RECREATIONAL CLUBHOUSE



ELEVATED WALKWAY



CLUBHOUSE LOBBY

- India's largest sports club on 5 acres, designed for 12 different sports
- 50+ amenities for wellness & an active lifestyle
- 35+ sports courts built to global standards
- Lifetime premium membership for residents
- Exclusive sports courts for futsal (7-a side), badminton & pickleball
- Elite recreational sports like bowling alley, squash, tennis, basketball & box cricket
- Indoor gaming zones with billiard, table tennis, board games
- Spa & wellness zone with a gym, sauna, steam, salon, therapy rooms & jacuzzi

INDIA'S
REVOLUTIONARY
SPORTS CLUBHOUSE

- Water retreats for every age with an indoor, Olympic-size, kids pool & a pool bar
- Curated dining experience with a restaurant, juice bar, sports bar & refreshment corner
- Rooftop cabanas & sky bar for elevated leisure
- Signature lounges for relaxation, recreation & socialising
- Elegant celebration venues with banquet hall, pre-function area and leisure lawn
- Convenience amenities like guest suites, business centre, medical centre & more
- Vibrant community spaces like viewing gallery, courtyard garden & central plaza

WHY
CASAGRANDBANG ON ORR

*T&C APPLY

No.1
Ranked in Chennai
for last 8 years*

Top 2
Ranked in
South India

Top 7
Ranked in
India

22+ years
of Trust &
Legacy

7000+
Homes sold in
FY'24 - 25

6 Cities
Chennai, Bengaluru, Hyderabad,
Pune, Coimbatore & Dubai

2 months
Guaranteed rental

6 months
Guaranteed resale

7 years
Warranty

10 years
Maintenance by us

2000+
Quality checks

On-time
Delivery of projects

98848 30000
EXCLUSIVE SITE VISIT AVAILABLE | VISIT MODEL HOUSE AT SITE



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NPL DEVI,111, LATTICE BRG RD,
THIRUVANMIYUR CHENNAI-600041

CASAGRANDBANG ON ORR
building aspirations

*Based on CBRE report 2024

Casagrand Premier Builder Limited is proposing, subject to receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offer of its equity shares and has filed a draft red herring prospectus ("DRHP") with the Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI"). The DRHP is available on the website of our Company, at www.casagrand.co.in, the SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in as well as on the websites of the book running lead managers Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited and DAM Capital Advisors Limited at www.motilaloswalgroup.com and www.damcapital.in respectively, and the websites of the stock exchange(s) at www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com, respectively. Any potential investor should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk and for details relating to such risk, see "Risk Factors" of the RHP, when available. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP filed with SEBI for making any investment decision.

The Equity Shares have not been and will not be registered under the U.S. Securities Act of 1933, as amended ("U.S. Securities Act") or any other applicable law of the United States and, unless so registered, may not be offered or sold within the United States except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable state securities laws. Accordingly, the Equity Shares are being offered and sold outside the United States in "offshore transactions" as defined in and in compliance with Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act and the applicable laws of the jurisdiction where those offers and sales occur.



NCRB REPORT
Overall crime rate drops 6%, cybercrimes go up
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Ahmedabad to host final, Bengaluru misses out
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DELIGHTFUL DAY
Sunrisers crush Kings, climb to the top
SPORT » PAGE 15

STRUCTURAL DEFICITS
Fixing India's health system
Medical education and public service need a greater alignment
EDITORIAL » PAGE 8



FIRST VISIT
India likely to host Rubio for talks in May
NEWS » PAGE 10

NEARBY


Plea in Madras HC seeks FIR against Vijay

CHENNAI
A writ petition filed in the Madras High Court has sought registration of an FIR against TVK president C. Joseph Vijay on the basis of income tax proceedings initiated after the release of his Tamil movie *Puli* in 2015. **» PAGE 6**



Steep quotes delay two key metro projects

CHENNAI
Two crucial projects to be developed by Chennai Metro Rail at Thirumangalam and Vadapalani have suffered a delay of a few months after discharging of exorbitant construction bids. **» PAGE 3**



Wet spell to ease summer heat across the State

CHENNAI
Temperatures during the first half of peak summer are likely to ease across the State as minor weather systems may trigger spells of heavy rainfall till May 12. **» PAGE 3**

METROPLUS » 4 PAGES

Nicobar gram sabhas signed off on infra project without 50% quorum

Abhinav Lakshman
NEW DELHI

The Andaman and Nicobar Islands (A&NI) administration did not achieve the mandated 50% quorum at the gram sabha meetings held to get consent for the Centre's ₹92,000-crore Great Nicobar Island project. Instead, it claimed to have done so by attendance figures ranging from 2% to 15% of the population, which, it argued in the Calcutta High Court, counted as "proper quorum". The submissions were made by the administration in an affidavit to the Bench that is hearing a batch of petitions alleging that procedures under the Forest Rights Act (FRA) had been violated in obtaining consent for the project. Quorum is the minimum number of members



Submissions before the Calcutta HC show that meetings to get nod for the ₹92,000-crore plan didn't have mandated strength. FILE PHOTO

needed in such a meeting to reach a decision. According to the rules issued by the Centre for the implementation of the FRA, a quorum at a gram sabha is achieved only if 'one-half' or 50% of the adult population of that village is in attendance, of which one-third must be women. The administration submitted that meetings were held for Campbell Bay,

Laxmi Nagar, and Govind Nagar gram panchayats, covering seven villages, on August 12, 2022. The Campbell Bay meeting was attended by 105 people, the one in Laxmi Nagar by 163 people, and the Govind Nagar sabha had 81 people. The administration said all three meetings passed "unanimous" resolutions consenting to the project. Compared to the popu-

lation of these gram panchayats as per the 2011 Census, the strength of the Campbell Bay meeting was 1.83% of the total population of 5,736, that of the Laxmi Nagar was 14.72% of the population of 1,107, and the attendance at the Govind Nagar meeting was 11.98% of the population of 676. Put together, 349 people (4.6%) signed off on the project at these three gram sabhas meant to represent seven villages, whose total population stood at 7,519 as of 2011. The submissions, which were taken on record by the High Court on Wednesday, came after the Centre sought time from the court to "demonstrate that consent has been taken from the tribal people".

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Trump pauses Hormuz move; says war will end if Iran agrees to deal

Stanly Johny

U.S. President Donald Trump on Wednesday paused "Project Freedom", launched on Monday and aimed at guiding stranded merchant ships through the Strait of Hormuz, citing "great progress" in talks with Iran. He added that the war could end if the Islamic Republic signed a deal, warning that the U.S. would resume bombing if it did not. When Mr. Trump announced the operation on Monday, he said any Iranian response would be dealt with "forcefully". Iran claimed that it fired at two U.S. destroyers in the strait and pushed them back while the UAE said it was attacked twice by missiles and drones and one of its tankers came under fire.



Uncertain waters: Vessels seen in the Strait of Hormuz off the Oman coast on Wednesday. REUTERS

Then came Mr. Trump's pause. "Based on the request of Pakistan and other countries... and... the fact that great progress has been made toward a complete and final agreement with Iran, we have mutually agreed that, while the blockade will remain in full force and effect, Project Freedom will be paused for a short period of time to see whether or not the

ran had exchanged proposals in recent days. In an interview, Esmail Baqaei, Foreign Ministry spokesperson, said Tehran was currently reviewing the American response to its proposal and would present its response through Pakistani mediators. Iran effectively closed the Strait of Hormuz after the U.S. and Israel started attacking the country on February 28. Active fighting came to an end on April 8, when Mr. Trump announced a ceasefire. But on April 12, the U.S. imposed a blockade on Iranian ports, heaping economic pressure on the country.

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'REVIEWING PROPOSALS'
» PAGE 14

Suvendu's aide among 3 killed as post-poll violence rocks Bengal



Shrabana Chatterjee
Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

Amid a rise in post-poll violence in West Bengal, unidentified assailants shot dead a close aide of Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) leader Suvendu Adhikari in North 24 Parganas district on Wednesday. The latest incident takes the number of deaths in the State linked to violence after the Assembly election results were announced on Monday to three. Chandranath Rath, the personal assistant of Mr. Adhikari, was reportedly shot three times at point-blank range in the Madhyamgram area. Mr. Rath was rushed to a hospital where he was declared dead. Earlier in the day, Mr. Adhikari, who is the front runner for the post of Chief Minister, had appealed for calm. The BJP registered a massive mandate in the election and Mr. Adhikari defeated Trinamool Congress leader and outgoing Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee in Bhabanipur. A BJP worker, Madhu Mondal, died after being allegedly beaten up by Trinamool cadres during a victory procession in New Town on Tuesday evening, while Trinamool worker Abir Sheikh was hacked to death, allegedly by BJP activists, in Birbhum the

same day. There have been reports of more deaths in violence, including one in Howrah, which the police have not confirmed yet. Several Trinamool offices have been vandalised over the past three days, while some were painted saffron to thwart attacks. The Director-General of Police, Siddh Nath Gupta, said 500 companies of Central forces remain deployed across the State to contain post-poll violence. The police have arrested 433 people across the State. Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar on Wednesday directed the West Bengal Chief Secretary, DGP, and Central Armed Police Forces deployed in the State to ensure zero tolerance towards post-poll violence by anyone. He directed the authorities concerned to immediately arrest those involved in violence and vandalism. On Tuesday night, bulldozers razed multiple structures in Kolkata's iconic New Market, triggering panic among shopkeepers who downed shutters. According to reports, the prime target was the Trinamool's union office, which was demolished.

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SWEARING-IN ON SATURDAY
» PAGE 11



Congress leader V.D. Satheesan at a roadshow in Paravur on Wednesday. THULASI KAKKAT

Ahead of AICC visit, jockeying for CM's post on in Kerala

G. Anand
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

With All India Congress Committee (AICC) observers Mukul Wasnik and Ajay Maken set to individually hear members of the Congress Legislature Party in Kerala on Thursday, jockeying by seemingly anonymous groups for the party's "competing" Chief Minister probabilities seemed to reach its zenith on Wednesday. For one, in an open letter to party leader Rahul Gandhi, a group under the banner of "Concerned Citizens of Kerala" argued that the Leader of the Opposition in the previous Assembly, V.D. Satheesan, was the architect of the United Democratic Front (UDF)'s historic win and hence the Chief Minister's mantle should fall on him naturally. Leaders of electorally significant social groups also seemed to have emerged as powerful behind-the-scenes figures in the Congress's leadership tussle, with Nair Service Society (NSS) general secretary G. Sukumaran Nair appearing to broadcast his "disapproval" of "certain positions" of Mr. Satheesan, and refusing to attribute the UDF's landslide victory to any one leader, saying that "democracy won".

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INBRIEF



B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

Complaint filed against MLA for cutting cake with sword

A complaint has been filed against the newly elected Royapuram MLA, K.V. Vijay Damu of the TVK, for cutting a cake with a sword on Wednesday. G.G. Siva, a social activist, submitted an online complaint to the Commissioner of Police, seeking action against Mr. Damu. He pointed out that similar incidents of cake-cutting in public places across the city had resulted in the arrest of several individuals. The MLA had cut a cake using a sword to celebrate his election victory, in the presence of TVK cadre, including Loyola Mani. The video of the celebration went viral on social media.

Youth assaulted over TVK song ringtone at hospital

A youth was assaulted by a group of persons at Kilpauk Government Medical College Hospital on Tuesday night. The police said the victim, Solomon, a resident of Otteri, had visited the hospital to enquire about the health of his uncle who was admitted there. While waiting at the hospital, his mobile phone rang to the ringtone of the TVK party's song. Enraged by this, a group of people had a heated argument with Solomon, asking him to pause the song. They then brutally assaulted him. The police have registered a case.

Text & Context and Science

Weekday features on *The Hindu* epaper (epaper.thehindu.com) carry explainers, special articles and quizzes. In the latest issue (May 7, Thursday), the following articles are available:

- When does a CM cease to hold office? newsth.live/mamatainbengal
- Invasive species may be the wrong enemy in a changing subcontinent newsth.live/alienspecies

You can use your smartphone's inbuilt features to access these articles. If it's an Android phone, use Google Lens to read and tap the url to access an article. If it's an iPhone, use Live Text on camera to do the same.

Residents call for judicious utilisation of hospital spaces in Tambaram, Chromepet

They raise concern over the underutilisation of two govt. hospital premises on GST Road and urge authorities to repurpose surplus space for emergency health services or other government needs

CITY MATTERS

T. Arvind
CHENNAI

While several government departments struggle for space and often operate from rented premises, residents and activists have raised concern over the underutilisation of two government hospital campuses along the GST Road in Tambaram and Chromepet.

The Government Leprosy Rehabilitation Promotion Unit in Tambaram, near the Madras Export Processing Zone (MEPZ), has been functioning for over three decades.

The multi-storeyed facility, spread across a large campus, caters to patients from the neighbouring districts. However, a visit to the premises indicates that occupancy remains low, with fewer than 10 inmates at a time, though officials say there are "13 to 15 inmates".

Senior social activist Santhanam questioned the use of such a large facility in a prime locality.

"If the number of patients is low, they can be shifted to another centre. The space can then be used for emergency health services or other government needs," he said, adding that the hospital was not clearly visible from the arterial road.



Wasted resource: The three-decade-old Government Leprosy Rehabilitation Promotion Unit in Tambaram, where patient occupancy remains low, with fewer than 10 inmates at a time. T. ARVIND

Officials say some inmates step out for banking or pension-related needs, though clarity on formal procedures governing such movement remains limited.

Long-term patients said they occasionally left the premises for personal needs after making entries in the register.

Medical Superintendent Noor Shahitha said the hospital had around 13 to 15 patients, with at least two doctors on duty daily, supported by nurses and other staff.

She added that only one of the three floors remained unused, while the others were earmarked for male and female wards. Security, she said, was monitored by the patrol police.

Ms. Shahitha added that patients were admitted not only from Chennai, but also from districts such as Tiruvallur, Chengalpattu, and Tiruvannamalai.

Vacant plot

The old Government Hospital in Chromepet, near the MIT Flyover, remains largely vacant after services were shifted to a nearby modernised facility last August.

At present, only a dental college hospital operates on the campus.

On the utilisation of space at the Tambaram Leprosy Rehabilitation Promotion Unit, Dr. Malarvizhi, Joint Director of Health Services, Chengalpattu, said any decision on shifting inmates or repurposing

space would require higher-level approval, though discussions were under way.

Renovation in progress

Referring to the old Government Hospital premises in Chromepet, she said the buildings were being renovated to house an Emergency Care and Recovery Centre for persons with mental illness and a one-stop centre for persons with disabilities. A proposal for a paramedical hostel is also under consideration.

Residents and activists stressed the need for timely and effective utilisation of these public assets, as the Pallavaram, Chromepet, and Tambaram regions continue to expand.

Enhanced security cover for Vijay withdrawn on TVK leaders' request

S. Vijay Kumar
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu police on Wednesday night withdrew the convoy and security scale given to TVK leader C. Joseph Vijay, official sources said.

The security protocol accorded to Mr. Vijay, which was on par with the Z-Plus scale given to the Tamil Nadu Chief Minister, was reduced to bare minimum.

Hours after the early indications during the counting of votes on May 4 pointed to a huge victory for the TVK, the police enhanced security arrangements at Mr. Vijay's residence and party office.

A senior officer in the rank of a Deputy Inspector-General of Police was deployed to supervise the security of Mr. Vijay.

More than a dozen armed commandos of the Security Branch CID of the

State police took charge of the bandobust. An access control system was also put in place, the sources said.

Two more officers in the rank of a Superintendent of Police were directed to report to the Inspector-General of Police, Intelligence.

However, a senior police officer said the security arrangements were withdrawn following a request by senior TVK leaders.

TVK office-bearer arrested for sexually harassing minor girl

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A 35-year-old man was arrested on charges of sexually harassing a minor girl on Wednesday.

The police said Dinesh, alias 'Pambu' Dinesh, a resident of Kasimedu and an office-bearer of the Tamila-ga Vetttri Kazhagam, had been absconding since Monday.

The incident occurred on April 23, when the girl visited her grandmother's house.

(ChildLine operates a toll-free helpline for children in distress -1098)

KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD
(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
No.2, 2/1 & 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar,
Bengaluru - 560009. Phone No. 080-22265383 website:www.kiadb.in

No. IADB/ENGG/ETND-EP-12/1102/2026-27

Date:05.05.2026

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER
(Through GOK KPP Portal Only)

Item Rate Tender under two cover bid system is invited as per the Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement Act 1999 and Rules 2000 through electronic procurement from eligible Contractors who have got adequate financial resources, suitable construction equipments, technical man power & sufficient past experience for the following works mentioned below:

Name of the works: (1) Formation of Roads including asphaltting, construction of RCC Side Drains, Inspection Chambers, Spur Culverts, Valve Cistern, Rain Water Harvesting & Water Supply Works at Sector-1 of Gowribidnur 4th Phase in Jarabandanahalli Village, Gowribidnur Taluk, Chikkaballapura District. (2) Formation of Roads including asphaltting, construction of RCC Side Drains, Inspection Chambers, Spur Culverts, Valve Cistern, Rain Water Harvesting & Water Supply Works at Sector-2 of Gowribidnur 4th Phase in Jarabandanahalli Village, Gowribidnur Taluk, Chikkaballapura District. (3) Establishment, Commissioning of 10 MLD Sewage Treatment Plant followed by 5 MLD Tertiary Treatment Plant along with 2 modules of 1.50 MLD each Common Effluent Treatment Plant with 1.50 MLD Capacity RO System & ZLD Facilities on total turnkey basis, including Operation & Maintenance of entire Plant for a period of 10 years at KWIN City at Phase-1 in Nelamangala Taluk, Bengaluru Rural District.

● Last Date & Time for Receipt of Tenders: **25.05.2026** upto **4:00 pm**.

Applicants May download bidding documents from the Karnataka Public Procurement portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>

Sd/- Chief Engineer-1
KIADB, Bengaluru

DIPR/CP/536/CCL/2026-27

ADMISSION NOTICE
Common Entrance Test-2026
FOR ADMISSION AT

INSTITUTE	COURSES
Pt. Deendayal Upadhyaya National Institute for Persons with Physical Disabilities (Divyangjan) (PDUNIPPD) 4, Vishnu Digamber Marg, New Delhi-110002 Website: https://pdunipdp.nic.in , E-mail: cetpdunipdp2026@gmail.com	• BPT • BOT • BPO
Swami Vivekanand National Institute of Rehabilitation Training and Research (DIVYANGJAN), Cuttack (SVNIRTAR) Olatpur, PO- Bairoi, Cuttack, Odisha - 754010 Website: https://svnirtar.nic.in , E-mail: nirtar@nic.in	• BPT • BOT • BPO • BASLP
National Institute for Locomotor Disabilities (DIVYANGJAN), Kolkata (NILD) B.T. Road, Bonhooghly, Kolkata -700090 website: https://nild.nic.in , E-mail: mail@nioh.in	• BPT • BOT • BPO
National Institute for Empowerment of Persons with Multiple Disabilities (DIVYANGJAN), Chennai (NIEPMD) East Coast Road, Muttukadu, Kovalam Post Chennai-603112, Website: www.niepmd.nic.in , E-mail: niepmd@gov.in	• BPT • BOT • BASLP
Ali Yavar Jung National Institute of Speech & Hearing Disabilities (Divyangjan), Mumbai (AYJNISHD(D)) K.C. Marg, Bandra (W) Reclamation Mumbai - 400 050 Website: http://ayjnishd.nic.in , E-mail: ayjnihh-mum@nic.in	• BASLP
Ali Yavar Jung National Institute of Speech & Hearing Disabilities (Divyangjan), Regional Centre, Kolkata NIEPID Campus, Manovikas Nagar, Bowenpally, Secunderabad Telengana -500009. Email: adsrc-nihh@ayjnihh.nic.in	• BASLP
Ali Yavar Jung National Institute of Speech & Hearing Disabilities (Divyangjan), Regional Centre, Secunderabad NIEPID Campus, Manovikas Nagar, Bowenpally, Secunderabad NILD Campus, B.T. Road, Bonhooghly, Kolkata - 700090 Website: adsrc-nihh@nic.in	• BASLP
Composite Regional Centre for Skill Development, Rehabilitation & Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities, (DIVYANGJAN), Guwahati (CRCSRE) Guwahati Medical College Hospital Campus Post Office Indrapur, GMC Hospital Rd, Bhangagarh, Guwahati, Assam - 781032 Website: https://crcguwahati.nic.in , E-mail rcrguwahati@gmail.com ,	• BASLP
Composite Regional Centre, Patna Sheikhpura, (Old Dharamshala), Near IGIMS Nursing College, Patna-800014 Website: https://rcrpatna.nic.in , E-mail: rcrpatna@rediffmail.com	• BPO

Eligibility: 10+2 Science with English as Compulsory Subject
Starting date of online Application: 11.05.2026 (Monday)
Closing date of online receipt of Application: 05.06.2026 (Friday)
Date of Entrance Test: 28.06.2026 (Sunday)

To Apply Online go to - <https://admission.svnirtar.nic.in>

For Furter Details Visit - <https://pdunipdp.nic.in>

All concerned may please note. cbc 38101/11/0002/2627

Director,
PDUNIPPD, New Delhi

18 Russian medical varsities to take part in education fair

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

As many as 18 leading medical universities of the Russian Federation will take part in an All India Russian Education Fair to be held across Tamil Nadu this month.

A total of 10,000 MBBS seats are on offer for Indian students at the fair, according to organisers.

Indian students who have cleared National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test and have scored at least 50% marks in relevant core subjects can apply for MBBS courses in Russia. For students from SC, ST, and OBC communities, the minimum marks required is 40%.

Speaking to reporters on Wednesday, Russian Consul General in Chennai Valerii Khodzhaev said his country had about 4,15,000 foreign students in 2025-26 and the number was expected to touch 4,25,000 by the end of the year.

The Russian government has set a target of attracting 5,00,000 foreign students by 2030. Working towards this, the government was improving academic and housing infrastructure at universities and creating a friendly and safe environment for the foreign students.

"Our universities offer some of the best educational programmes," Mr. Khodzhaev said, adding, "We are able to keep our prices reasonable because of the high purchasing power in Russia." MBBS fees in Russia can be as low as ₹3.5 lakhs to ₹5 lakh per annum.

The fair will be held in Chennai on May 9 and 10 at the Russian Centre of Science and Culture

The fair will see participation from educational institutions teaching science, technology, and engineering and those offering programmes in emerging domains like biotechnology, artificial intelligence, and data science.

Alexander Dodonov, Vice Consul and Director, Russian House, said full scholarships were also being offered to about 220 Indian students this year.

C. Ravi Chandran, Managing Director, Study Abroad Educational Consultants, said Russia had 63 public medical universities and more than 600 universities for humanities, sciences, and engineering. "Nearly 98% of Indian students in Russia are medical students. That is because it is the only country where institutions satisfied the latest norms set by the National Medical Council," Dr. Chandran added.

Berezhanskiy Pavel Vacheslavovich, professor of Child Diseases, Sechenov's University, also spoke.

The fair will take place in Chennai between 10 a.m. and 5 p.m. on May 9 and 10 at the Russian Centre of Science and Culture. It will then be held at Hotel Royal Court in Madurai on May 12, Hotel Femina in Tiruchi on May 13, GRT Hotel Zibe in Salem on May 14, and The Grand Regent Hotel in Coimbatore the next day. For more details, contact 92822221221.

UTTAR PRADESH MEDICAL SUPPLIES CORPORATION LTD.
(A Government of Uttar Pradesh Undertaking)
Tender Notice
Tender Ref.No: UPMSCL/Drugs-255/04 Dated: 29th April, 2026
e-TENDER FOR SUPPLY OF DRUGS
Online tenders are invited from licensed manufacturers for supply of drugs to UPMSCL. The details of tender, list of items and Tender Documents are made available on website <https://etender.up.nic.in> and www.upmscl.in. The last date/time of online submission of the tender documents is **20th May, 2026** upto 15:00 Hrs.
Managing Director
UPMSCL, Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh
Department of Medical Health & Family Welfare, Uttar Pradesh

THE HINDU
Air Surcharge as applicable:
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Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

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MUSIC DANCE DRAMA
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Today: From 6.00 p.m. to 7.30 p.m. At the Kasturi Srinivasan Hall - Namasankirtanam by V. Karthick Ganeswar & Party - Programme under the endowment of Abhang Ratna Sri. Ganesh Kumar in memory of Swami Haridhoshgiri.

KRISHNA GANA SABHA
"Dr.Nalli Gana Vihar,T.Nagar, Ph:28140806"
SUMMER DRAMA FEST 2026:
TODAY : 07.05.26: 7.00 PM: KARPANAI KUTHIRAI PRESENTS "CHIKKU BUKKU KALYANAM" - WRITTEN & DIRECTED BY VEDARUNRAJAKUMAR
TOMORROW: 08.05.26: 7.00 PM: FATHIMA BABU FAB'S THEATRE PRESENTS "UN KANNIL NEER VAZHINDHAL" STORY & DIALOGUES T.V.RADHAKRISHNAN, DIRECTION : FATHIMA BABU
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book show & SABHA OFFICE
CAFÉ: SATIVAA
VALET PARKING AVAILABLE
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Swaminatha Thala Vidhyalaya, 24992672
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S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER
E-Tender Notice No.: TRD-ADA-e-Tender-04-2026, dated: 05.05.2026.
Asst. Divisional Elect. Engineer (TRD), South Eastern Railway, Adra invites E-Tender for the following work: **Description of work:** Modification of OHE arrangements to eliminate live part on platform. **Approx. Tender Value:** ₹ 8,24,47,408.13. The closing date and time of e-tender-04-2026 for works above is on **26.05.2026 at 15.00 hrs.** and its opening of tender will be done on **26.05.2026 after 15.00 hrs.** Details of above e-tender may please be seen at website www.irops.gov.in (PR-129)

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I, Anantu Thampi Rajesh, 22 years, Son of Rajesh E.R. R/o. Majestic Orchard Ben Foundation, Lilly B5, Reddypalayam Road, Mogappair West Chennai- 600037, have changed my name from Anantu Thampi Rajesh to Anantu Thampi for all future purposes vide Affidavit Dated: 10.04.2026
I, hitherto known as Vanitha K alias Vanitha Karunakaran D/o P. Karunakaran and wife of Sathiyakumar Seshachalam, resident of 413-F2, Rasi Builders, 13th East Street, Kamaraj Nagar, Thiruvanniyur, Chennai, Tamil Nadu - 600041; have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Vanitha Sathyakumar.
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INBRIEF



R. RAGU

Wet spell to offer State respite from heat till May 12

Temperatures during the first half of peak summer, popularly known as the *Agni Natchathiram* period, are likely to ease across Tamil Nadu, as minor weather systems may trigger spells of heavy rain in southern and interior districts till May 12. Some parts of Chennai, including Ambattur, Besant Nagar and Korattur, received mild showers in the last two days. Though light rainfall may continue in the city on Thursday, the humidity levels are expected to remain high. Peak mercury levels have stayed below the 40-degree mark for the past two days in the State, offering respite from the scorching heat.

Overseas scholarship for Adi Dravidar, tribal students

The Adi Dravidar and Tribal Welfare Department has invited applications for scholarships under Annal Ambedkar Overseas Higher Education Scholarship Scheme for academic year 2026-27 from students belonging to the Adi Dravidar community, Adi Dravidar converts to Christianity, and tribal communities to pursue higher education abroad. Candidates should have got admission to a Master's or a PhD programme at a foreign university ranked within the top 1000 as per QS World University Rankings, and their annual family income should not exceed ₹12 lakh. The Master's applicant should not be above 35 years and the PhD candidate not above 40 years. Eligible candidates may apply online through websites www.tnadw.gov.in/overseas_scholarship or www.tnadwscholarship.in between May 5 and June 5.

Metro projects at Vadapalani, Thirumangalam face minor delays owing to steep quotes

At Thirumangalam, the CMRL's plan was to integrate the upcoming station in the 118.9-km phase II network with four towers where people can shop, dine, or work, and hop onto a train to commute

TRACK TALES

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

Two crucial projects to be developed by Chennai Metro Rail at Thirumangalam and Vadapalani have suffered a delay of a few months.

While at Thirumangalam, the Chennai Metro Rail's plan was to integrate the upcoming station in the 118.9-km phase II network (with three corridors) with four towers where people can shop, dine, or work, and hop onto a train to commute; at Vadapalani, a depot with an integrated bus terminal and commercial complex was to come up.

According to officials of Chennai Metro Rail Limited (CMRL), though they had floated bids last year for carrying out the construction of these two projects, it had to be discharged owing to exorbitant quotes placed by bidders.

"This is because prospective bidders had submitted steep quotes for both the projects and it was not unjustified at all. We cannot go ahead with



Expansive facility: An artist's impression of the proposed project in Vadapalani.

such prices. We modified the bids again to prevent this issue from occurring again. So, for Thirumangalam, we already floated the bids sometime back and once the Model Code of Conduct, which was imposed for the elections, is lifted, we will award the contract. As far as Vadapalani's project is concerned, we will issue the bids shortly. There is only a minor delay of a month or two," an official said.

The Thirumangalam project is a unique one in the phase II network and to which most commuters have been looking for-

ward. Over an area of 3.85 acres, the four towers, including the phase II Chennai Metro Rail station will come up at Thirumangalam and this will be part of corridor 5 (from Madhavaram to Sholinganallur via Thirumangalam and Medavakkam).

Such a design gives commuters the ease of accessing public transport within the same space as that of commercial establishments and office spaces.

In the first three towers, there will be a ground and nine upper floors. The phase II station will be situated on the third and

fourth floor of the second tower. In the first and the third tower, there will also be three basements. The fourth tower will include a ground and two floors.

The Vadapalani project coming up over 6.65 acres on Arcot Road aims to modernise one of the busiest depots handling over 1,000 bus services daily. It will turn into a multi-modal transit hub with a modern bus terminal that will have five boarding bays, two alighting bays, passenger amenities, office spaces, massive parking facilities, food court, and retail outlets.

Experts to discuss post-partum care at webinar tomorrow

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Kauvery Hospital, in collaboration with *The Hindu*, will host on May 8 a webinar on 'Post-partum Care for Mothers', as part of its wellness series, to commemorate Mothers' Day.

The post-partum phase involves not only physical recovery after childbirth but also dealing with emotional adjustments, hormonal changes, and the demands of newborn care. The session aims at offering expert insights into holistic recovery.

At the webinar, K. Then-dral, Clinical Lead and Senior Consultant, Obstetrics and Gynaecology, Kauvery Hospital, Radial Road, will speak on 'General Post-partum Care and Lactation'; P. Sathya Sudhakar, Consultant Obstetrician



and Gynaecologist, Kauvery Hospital, Salem, will make a presentation on 'Mental Health and Support Systems'; and Manjeswari G., Psychologist and Sexual Health Therapist, Maa Kauvery, Trichy, will deal with 'Sexual Well-being and Exercises for Post-partum Mothers'. Journalist Soma Basu will moderate the session, which will be held at 11.30 a.m. on May 8.

Those interested may register on <https://newsth.live/THKMOE>.



Chennai Weather

max min

Tiruvallur 40 27

Chennai Airport 39 30

Chennai City 36 30

Chennai Airport Today

37°C Morning will be comfortable. Day will be very warm and uneasy. Night also will be comfortable. Dry weather is likely.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow

38°C The weather will be dry. Day will be slightly hot and uneasy. Night will be comfortable.

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Timings

CHENNAI

THURSDAY, MAY. 07

RISE 05:47 SET 18:25

RISE 23:15 SET 09:56

FRIDAY, MAY. 08

RISE 05:46 SET 18:26

RISE 23:59 SET 10:48

SATURDAY, MAY. 09

RISE 05:46 SET 18:26

RISE 00:00 SET 11:40

THE HINDU

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SRMIST launches Mission Mausam Urban Testbed to boost monsoon prediction

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

SRM Institute of Science and Technology, Ramapuram, on Wednesday launched the Mission Mausam Urban Testbed and observational facilities, developed by Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology (IITM) under the Ministry of Earth Sciences.

The facility is aimed at monitoring aerosols, clouds, precipitation, atmospheric dynamics, and thermodynamic parameters across the city to enhance monsoon prediction and provide early warnings of severe weather.

M. Ravichandran, Secretary, Ministry of Earth Sciences, inaugurated the facility in the presence of A. Suryachandra Rao, Director, IITM, Pune; R. Shivakumar, Chairman, SRMIST, Ramapuram, Chennai & Trichy; Thara Prabhakaran, Project Director, IITM; and



SRMIST and IIT-M signs an MoU to facilitate collaboration in research and academic activities in weather and climate sciences. M. SRINATH

M. Sakthi Ganesh, Dean (E&T), SRMIST.

"Mission Mausam was established to revolutionise early action on weather and its impact," Ms. Prabhakaran said. "All components of energy and water are observed and modelled to better forecast and inform decision-making, so as to alleviate the adverse impacts of severe weather," she added. "While this partnership is rooted in engineering, atmospheric

science, and technology, its ultimate impact will be felt in the health and well-being of the people," Dr. Shivakumar said.

‘Propose new ideas’

Mr. Rao asked the young researchers and students in the audience to use the facility as a tool to challenge existing theories and propose new hypotheses.

Furthermore, Mr. Ravichandran said Mission Mausam was one of the projects

that received quick approval from the Central government.

He added that since Chennai was a natural laboratory for tropical weather, observing its weather patterns was essential, hence the launch of the observatory in the city.

Centre inaugurated

Inaugural of SRMIST's Centre for Atmospheric Sciences Research and Innovation also took place, along with the signing of an MoU between SRMIST and IITM. The MoU will facilitate collaboration in research and academic activities in weather and climate sciences.

Balaji Ramakrishnan, Director, National Institute of Ocean Technology, Chennai; R.S. Kankara, Director, National Centre for Coastal Research; S.D. Pai, Regional Meteorological Centre, IMD Chennai; and Mr. Ganesh also spoke.

Online process to join arts and science colleges begins today

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Students seeking admission to first year undergraduate degree programmes in government arts and science colleges in the State for the academic year 2026-27 may register online from May 7. The application fee per student is ₹48 while the registration fee is ₹2. For students from SC and ST communities, the application fee has been waived. Those who are unable to apply online independently could submit their applications through Admission Facilitation Centres (AFC) at all government arts and science colleges. Last day for registration is May 29. For admission-related queries, contact the Directorate of Collegiate Education help centre at 044-24343100 and 24342011 between 10 a.m. and 5 p.m. on weekdays.

IN LOVING
Memory

Prof. S.Soundarapandian

04.07.1931-07.05.2025

A year without you, yet your love, values and guidance continue to shape our lives everyday

Deeply missed and forever cherished

By
His Beloved Wife, Children, Grandchildren, and Great-Grandchildren

Soundarapandian
Bharathi and Jaya Hospital
Ramapuram

V.O.Chidambaranar Port Authority
General Administration Department, Tuticorin
(An Autonomous Body under MoPSW, Govt)

GAD-EST10ESTC(EST)/8/2023-GAD(4848)/D. Date:07.05.2026

V.O. Chidambaranar Port Authority invites applications for the following Position:-
Engagement of Assistant Director (Project) on contractual basis:

Position	No. of position	Monthly Remuneration
Assistant Director (Project)	1	Rs. 1,40,000

For details regarding upper age limit, educational qualifications, etc., visit VOC Ports' website at www.vocport.gov.in (careers). Last date for the receipt of applications is 27.05.2026.

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Government of Karnataka
DEPARTMENT OF MINES & GEOLOGY
#49, Khanija Bhavan, Race Course Road, Bengaluru-560001
E-mail: dir-mines@karnataka.gov.in

No. DMG-17012/26/2025/2026-27 Dated: 06.05.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

The Department of Mines and Geology is calling tender for auction of seized generated iron ore fines under respective notification through MSTC. Eligibility conditions, terms and conditions, date and time for participating in the electronic auction are provided in the Tender Document. Separate Lot wise auction notifications are published in MSTC portal. Tender Documents, notifications, updates and other details for the e-auction process of respective lots shall be available in electronic form only at the website of MSTC Ltd.

<https://www.mstcecommerce.com/auctionhome/aucsearch/search.jsp>
The auction of old stock for each lot is "AS IS WHERE IS AND NO COMPLAINT BASIS". The interested bidders shall ascertain the quantity and quality of the Iron /Manganese ore before participation. The Department is not responsible for any dispute arising after confirmation of the bid.

Interested bidders may visit the MSTC Ltd website.

Sd/-
Director,
Department of Mines & Geology

DIPR/CP/533/NR/2026-27

TAMIL NADU EX-SERVICEMEN CORPORATION LIMITED
NOTICE INVITING TENDER

SCHEDULES ATTACHED TO AND FORMING PART OF GROUP PERSONAL ACCIDENT (NAMED) INSURANCE POLICY FOR CONTRACT PERSONNEL OF TEXCO

1. The Insured M/s. Tamil Nadu Ex-servicemen Corporation Limited, Chennai – 600 035.
2. Risks Covered : In Group Personal Accident Insurance world wide coverage (24 X 7) in Table III as per the Guidelines of IRDA. The benefits required to be covered shall be as under :-

Table	Benefits																								
III	1. Death only (100% of sum insured). 2. Loss of two limbs, loss of sight of two eyes (100% sum insured). 3. Loss of one limb or loss of sight of one eye (50% of sum insured). 4. Permanent Total Disablement from injuries other than named above (100% of Capital Sum Insured) 5. Permanent Partial Disablement % age of compensation as shown below																								
	<table><thead><tr><th>Permanent Partial Disablement (Benefit No.5)</th><th>Compensation of percentage of capital sum insured.</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>Loss of toes all</td><td>20</td></tr><tr><td>Great – Both Phalanges</td><td>05</td></tr><tr><td>Great – One Phalanx</td><td>02</td></tr><tr><td>Other than great, if more than one toe lost each</td><td>01</td></tr><tr><td>Loss of hearing both ears</td><td>50</td></tr><tr><td>Loss of hearing one ear</td><td>15</td></tr><tr><td>Loss of four fingers & Thumb of one hand</td><td>40</td></tr><tr><td>Loss of four fingers</td><td>35</td></tr><tr><td>Loss of thumb both phalanges</td><td>25</td></tr><tr><td>One Phalanx</td><td>10</td></tr><tr><td>Temporary Total Disablement</td><td>1 % of the capital sum insured not exceeding INR 20,000 per week but not more than 100 weeks</td></tr></tbody></table>	Permanent Partial Disablement (Benefit No.5)	Compensation of percentage of capital sum insured.	Loss of toes all	20	Great – Both Phalanges	05	Great – One Phalanx	02	Other than great, if more than one toe lost each	01	Loss of hearing both ears	50	Loss of hearing one ear	15	Loss of four fingers & Thumb of one hand	40	Loss of four fingers	35	Loss of thumb both phalanges	25	One Phalanx	10	Temporary Total Disablement	1 % of the capital sum insured not exceeding INR 20,000 per week but not more than 100 weeks
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3. Persons Covered Named 8959 (8957 contract personnel + 2 regular employees) personnel deployed to the projects and Head Office & Branch Offices of TEXCO.
4. Period of Insurance Insurance cover shall be for a period of 12 months (i.e. 01.06.2026 to 31.05.2027) taking into consideration the period between the date of joining/ cessation of contract/removal of individual.
5. Sum Insured Rs.5,00,000/-(Rupees Five lakh per person)
6. Sharing Pattern 100 % share shall be awarded by the L1 insurance company.
7. Publishing Date - available from 07.05.2026 at 10.00 A.M in web portal www.tntenders.gov.in
8. Document Download/Sale - 07.05.2026 at 10.05 A.M. in web portal www.tntenders.gov.in
9. Seek clarification start date - 07.05.2026 at 12.00.P.M
10. Seek clarification end date - 18.05.2026 at 11.00. A.M
11. Pre bid meeting - 18.05.2026 at 11.00. A.M
12. Bid submission starting date- 07.05.2026 at 12.00.P.M
13. Bid submission closing date - 20.05.2026 at 11.00.A.M
14. Bid Opening date - 20.05.2026 at 03.00. P.M
The schedule of tender form could also be down loaded, free of cost from the Government web portal www.tntenders.gov.in and TEXCO website www.texco.tn.gov.in
General Manager
TEXCO

DIPR/1834/TEN/2026

‘Outer Ring Road belt is emerging as a strategic hotspot for investment’

Experts at a roundtable say the corridor is emerging as a strategic hotspot for urban expansion as it connects multiple routes; they also cite real estate boom in cities that have built ring roads

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Outer Ring Road (ORR) belt is emerging as a strategic hotspot for future urban expansion and investment, real estate experts said during a round table discussion titled ‘Chennai’s Next Expansion - Why ORR will define it’. “The ORR is the first major ring road development that connects multiple routes. Starting from Vandalur, it touches the Chennai-Bengaluru highway,” said Jerry Kingsley, Head of Research India and City Lead for Capital Markets (Chennai) at JLL, at the event which was presented by Casagrand on the topic ‘The Hindu Outer Ring Road-Chennai Advantage: Where Smart Investment Begins’. The round table discussion was moderated by Prince Fredrick, Civic Affairs Editor, *The Hindu*. Mr. Jerry cited examples of what Hyderabad and Beijing had done. “If you look at Beijing, it has five different rings - this is a good development model. When Hyderabad ORR came, there was a real estate boom and an escalation in price by 10-15%. It also gave connectivity to commercial hubs,” he said.



A panel discussion moderated by Prince Fredrick, Civic Affairs Editor at *The Hindu*, featured insights from Jerry Kingsley, head of Research India and City Lead-capital markets (Chennai) at JLL; Karthik Bhatt, historian and author; Janakaram, president of SaciWATERS, and Dipta Kirti Chaudhuri, chief marketing officer at Casagrand. R. RAVINDRAN

Mr. Jerry cited another example of how land prices went up on the Radial Road. “In 2005, the land value on Radial Road was ₹10 lakh to ₹15 lakh per acre. Now we are talking about ₹50 crore to ₹55 crore per acre,” he said. Diptakirti Chaudhuri, CMO of Casagrand, said that ORR is like a connector of corridors. Sharing details about the group’s Thirumudivakkam project he said, “We are in the process of launching it. We will start construction soon. It is a 41-acre project. We are trying to create residential units along with social in-

frastructure.” Mr. Chaudhuri also explained how the company realised that ORR would grow fast. “We realised that people want a certain kind of living—one that includes increasingly spacious homes, closeness to nature, and ample opportunities for children to grow away from pollution and congestion. We need to adopt a lifestyle similar to the West, where people live in the suburbs and work wherever necessary,” he added. Karthik Bhatt, Historian and Author, spoke about how Chennai grew over the years. “T. Nagar developed to ad-

dress the housing needs of people,” he said. Likewise ORR is also developing based on need as congestion is high in the city. Janakaram, President, South Asia Consortium for Interdisciplinary Water Resources Studies, said, “Before the development of any urban infrastructure it is extremely important for us to understand what is the location advantage and disadvantage.”

ORR best positioned to address all problems of a home buyer: expert

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Outer Ring Road (ORR) is where the next wave for housing will happen, said Gautam Agarwal, Chief Operating Officer of Casagrand.

“There are no large land parcels within the city. ORR addresses all the problems which a home buyer has,” he said during a round table discussion with Rosella Stephen, Property Plus Editor and Ideas Editor, *The Hindu*, on the topic ‘The ORR Opportunity: Infrastructure, Liveability, and Long Term Value’. The event was presented by Casagrand.

Mr. Agarwal said that ORR has fueled growth of cities across the world. Hyderabad has seen this success and growth and ORR will do the same magic to Chennai, he added. “Buyers in Chennai are asking for better living spaces. They are very conscious and ask whether the area would flood or not. We help them navigate all these issues,” he explained.

He also spoke about the largest candy-themed inflatable park that has been set up at Casagrand property. “The theme park has been doing good. It is getting a good response and we are sold out everyday,” he said.

Sanjay Chugh, City Lead and Director of ANAROCK



Sanjay Chugh, director and city lead-land transactions at ANAROCK Property Consultants Private Limited; Gautam Agarwal, chief operating officer at Casagrand; Karthik Nagappan, CEO of Super Chennai; and Vidhya Mohankumar, founder and principal of Urban Design Collective, at a session moderated by Rosella Stephen, Ideas Editor, *The Hindu*, in Chennai on Wednesday. R. RAVINDRAN

Property Consultants Private Limited, spoke on what is needed on ORR.

“The biggest thing we really need to create on ORR is infrastructure. We have a great road. But beyond the road, we need to build social infrastructure. You need reliable piped water, proper drainage systems, and consistent power supply. If you want to attract people, you need to build a complete ecosystem around them. Growth happens by creating jobs, housing, and retail—this is how development follows,” he said.

To a query on whether ORR would have sufficient water supply, Mr. Chugh said: “I don’t see water being an issue as of now and the quality of water here is good. It will take another 30-40 years for ORR to see water shortage.” He also noted that this corridor does not have any pollut-

ing industries and has more warehouses.

‘30-minute city’ Karthik Nagappan, CEO of Super Chennai, said, “One of the biggest outcomes of the Super Chennai enclave is the vision of a 30-minute city—where residential and work clusters are within a convenient 30-minute reach, enabling better work-life balance. The ORR is uniquely positioned to bring this to life, with its strong connectivity, available land parcels, and the right ecosystem to drive this transformation, setting a benchmark for future urban development.”

He then added: “In Chennai, educational institutions have always grown in the suburbs. There are places you can stop and have a great view.”

“Earlier, most people would travel to T. Nagar or Tambaram for their needs.

Today, places like Urapakam and Guduvanchery have well-known brands every ten minutes. This transformation happened because of developments such as Shriram City, SRM University, and Mahindra World City,” Mr. Nagappan said.

Vidhya Mohankumar, Founder and Principal of Urban Design Collective, said that ORR is a green-field development which is an advantage.

“ORR is already growing at this point. The question now is how will it grow,” she said. She also pointed out that although OMR is an economic success, it still has several shortcomings—for instance, even after 20 years, basic infrastructure like sewage connections remains inadequate. She said that things like this should be factored in while developing ORR.



COUNCIL OF SCIENTIFIC AND INDUSTRIAL RESEARCH (CSIR)

Anusandhan Bhawan, 2, Rafi Marg, New Delhi-110001

Advt. No. 02/2026

CSIR invites applications/nominations for the position of Chairperson, CSIR-Recruitment and Assessment Board (CSIR-RAB), New Delhi, in Level 16 of pay-matrix (Rs. 2,05,400-2,24,400) plus allowances as admissible or such consolidated pay as recommended by the Search cum Selection Committee.

For eligibility criteria and other conditions, please see the detailed/complete advertisement No. 02/2026 on CSIR website www.csir.res.in. Applications /nominations may be sent along with complete bio-data through email at drc.hqrs@csir.res.in or by post to Director Recruitment Cell, Council of Scientific & Industrial Research (CSIR), Anusandhan Bhawan, 2, Rafi Marg, New Delhi-110001 on or before 15/06/2026.

CBC 36202/11/0001/2627

CORRIGENDUM NO. 1 AGAINST TENDER NOTICE NO. CON/2026/APR/01 DATED: 07-04-2026

Corrigendum- 1 has been issued against Tender No. CE/CON/KJG/EPC/2026/03. For details please visit www.irops.gov.in

Chief Engineer/CON/Meghalaya Project, Maligaon

NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY (Construction Organisation)

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CENTRAL RAILWAY

REMODELING WORK

Open E-Tender Notice No.: BS.LD.585.W.893.CONTR3 of Date: 04.05.2026

Name of work: Tender No.: BS.LD.585.W.893.CONTR3 for 25 KV AC OHE Modification work in connection with Extension of Platform No. 4,5,6 and Yard Remodeling Work at CSMT for 15 Car Suburban Train in Mumbai Division.

Approx Value: ₹4,73,78,462/-, Bid Security: ₹9,47,500/-, Cost of Tender Form: Nil, Completion Period: 12 Months, Validity of Offer: 60 Days, I.Tender Closing Date & Time of aforesaid Tender: Upto 11.00 hrs. of 26.05.2026 and will be opened after 11.00 hrs., II. The prospective tenderers are requested to visit the website www.irops.gov.in for details of tenders & corrigendum, if any, III. Tender may participate in above e-tender electronically through website www.irops.gov.in only & submission of manual offers against e-tender are not allowed. Manually, if submitted shall neither be opened nor considered, IV. Bid Security should be paid as per details given in tender document, V. For further enquiry, may contact: Senior Divisional Electrical Engineer (Traction Distribution), Mumbai Division, Central Railway, Annex Building, 2nd floor, Mumbai CSMT-400001 on Phone 022-22612355. Complete Details of Tenders are available at the website www.irops.gov.in. The complete details of tenders are also available in the "Notice Board" of the Senior Divisional Electrical Engineer (Traction Distribution), Mumbai CSMT-400001.

Sr. DEE(TD)BB

IT IS FORBIDDEN TO CROSS THE RAILWAY GATE IN CLOSED POSITION



Bangalore Electricity Supply Company Limited

(A wholly owned Government of Karnataka Undertaking)

(CIN: U04010KA2002SGC030438)

NOTIFICATION INVITING TENDER (NIT) (Through e-procurement portal)

No:BESCOM/CGM(Proj)/DGM-1/AGM-1/BC-14/26-27/Cys-34

BESCOM Re-invites the tenders for "Providing Electrical infrastructure to the regularized IP sets by extending 11 KV lines, Erection of 25 KVA Star 1 (4 Star) rated Distribution Transformers and Extension of LT line on Partial Turnkey basis (25 KVA Distribution Transformer will be supplied by BESCOM) under PERCENTAGE QUOTING BASIS in BESCOM" with the following tender enquiry nos.

Sl. No.	Enquiry No's	Name of the Sub Division
1	BESCOM/2025-26/EL/WORK_INDENT878/CALL-2	Kanakapura USD
2	BESCOM/2025-26/EL/WORK_INDENT880/CALL-2	Yadiyur
3	BESCOM/2025-26/EL/WORK_INDENT881/CALL-2	Sathanur
4	BESCOM/2025-26/EL/WORK_INDENT882/CALL-2	Bangarapete
5	BESCOM/2025-26/EL/WORK_INDENT889/CALL-2	Channappattana RSD
6	BESCOM/2025-26/EL/WORK_INDENT890/CALL-2	Tumakuru RSD-2
7	BESCOM/2025-26/EL/WORK_INDENT892/CALL-2	Gowribidanuru
8	BESCOM/2025-26/EL/WORK_INDENT900/CALL-2	Harihara
9	BESCOM/2025-26/EL/WORK_INDENT908/CALL-2	Teligi
10	BESCOM/2025-26/EL/WORK_INDENT909/CALL-2	Tiptur
11	BESCOM/2025-26/EL/WORK_INDENT911/CALL-2	Hosadurga
12	BESCOM/2025-26/EL/WORK_INDENT913/CALL-2	Chitradurga Rural

Availability of Bid documents: 13.05.2026 onwards. Last date for submission of bid Queries: 18.05.2026 before 17:00 Hrs. Pre-Bid meeting: 19.05.2026 at 11:00 Hrs. Venue of Pre-Bid meeting: Conference Hall, 3rd Floor, BELAKU BHAVANA, Corporate office, BESCOM, K. R Circle, Bengaluru- 560 001. Last date & Time for bid submission: 25.05.2026 at 15:00 Hrs. Opening of Technical Bids: 26.05.2026 at 15:30 Hrs. The bid documents can be downloaded and necessary assistance can be obtained through the e-procurement portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>, E-procurement Help Desk: Phone No: +91-8046010000 +91-8068948777, E-mail: support@eprocelpdesk.com

Aspiring bidders needs to be registered on e-procurement portal. Bidders can take the assistance from the e-procurement during office working hours.

Sd/-Chief General Manager (Ele)Projects, BESCOM.
E mail: cgmproject.bescom@gmail.com

For Electricity related complaints call: 1912
Download BESCOM Mithra Mobile APP

BUSINESS CONNECT

A Business Initiative

GRT Jewellers Opens in Cuddalore



GRT Jewellers announces the relocation of its Cuddalore showroom to a bigger, grander, showroom on Imperial Road. To celebrate this new beginning, GRT Jewellers is extending exclusive offers to its customers. Customers can avail Rs. 250 less per gram on Gold Jewellery Purchase, Rs.100 extra per gram on Old Gold Jewellery Exchange, 12.5 percent off on Diamond and uncut diamond value except solitaires, 25 percent off on wastage (VA) for Silver Articles, and 10 percent off on MRP of Silver Jewellery. Speaking on the occasion, Mr G.R. 'Anand' Ananthapadmanabhan, MD, GRT Jewellers, shared "We are deeply thankful to our customers for their unwavering support, which motivates us to keep growing and creating memorable jewellery shopping experiences." Adding to this, Mr G.R. Radhakrishnan, MD, GRT Jewellers, remarked: "Every milestone in our journey is made possible by the trust our customers place in us."

Indian Oil Reassures Public on LPG

Mr. V C Asokan, State Level Co-ordinator of the Oil Industry in Tamil Nadu, issued an important statement to reassure the public about the availability of petroleum products and LPG. He confirmed that adequate stocks of petrol and diesel are available at all retail outlets across Tamil Nadu and Puducherry, urging citizens against panic buying. The supply chain—from refineries to retail outlets—is functioning smoothly, with continuous monitoring to ensure uninterrupted availability. Mr. Asokan also highlighted that Oil Marketing Companies (IOC, BPC, and HPC) are maintaining seamless supplies of domestic LPG, with delivery waiting periods reduced to less than five days in most areas. Auto LPG stocks are also sufficient at retail outlets. He urged the public to continue normal consumption patterns, assuring that OMCs are committed to reliable energy access for all consumers.

VIS Records 100% Result in 10th ICSE



Vellore International School (VIS), Chennai proudly announces an outstanding academic achievement, with a 100 percent pass result in the Grade 10 ICSE Board Examinations for the Batch of 2026. The cohort has also achieved an impressive class average of 76 percent, reflecting the school's unwavering commitment to academic excellence. This milestone stands as a testament to the visionary leadership of Chairman Dr. G. V. Selvam, whose guidance continues to inspire and shape the institution's ethos and pursuit of excellence. Vellore International School remains dedicated to nurturing well-rounded, future-ready learners, and this accomplishment further reinforces its reputation as a centre of excellence in holistic education. The journey of success continues.

Challani Celebrates 13th Anniversary



Challani Jewellery Mart celebrated its 13th Anniversary at Grand Sherraton recently amidst much pomp and splendor. Mr.Ravi, IPS, Mr.Isari Ganesh, Mr.Vikramaraja, Mr.Varadarajan, Sowbhagya, Mr.Jayantilal Challani, Mrs.Hemalatha Jayantilal, Mr.Rishub Challani, Mr.Goutham Challani, Mr.Sripal Challani and many other personalities participated. 52 employees were rewarded with TV, Washing Machine and Refrigerator and 8 employees were gifted with plots worth 15 lakhs each for their contribution to the growth of the organisation. Mr.Erode Magesh and Mr.Ramakrishnan addressed the gathering with their powerful speeches. Staff staged their dance performances much to the thrill of the audience. The whole day was filled with fun, achievements and recognition. Mr.Elayaraja, VP gave the vote of thanks.

Dr. Raghavan Recognised in Kolkata



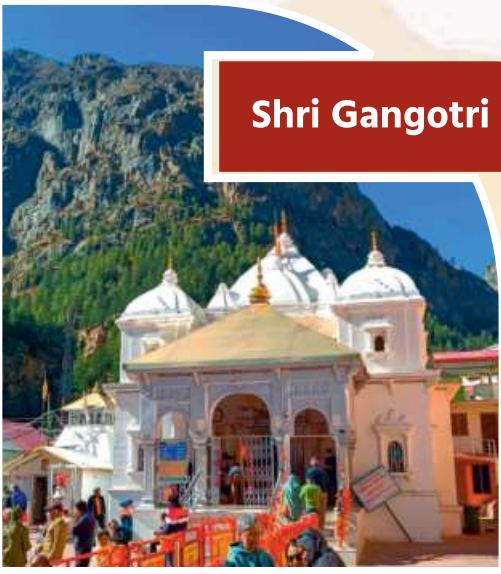
Arun Raghavan, Diabetologist and Metabolic Physician, Revivo Clinic was conferred the " Excellence in Obesity Care Award " by the Association of Metabolic Obesity Physicians and Clinical Endocrinologists at Kolkata, in recognition of his contributions in advancing comprehensive Obesity and Metabolic care. The Award highlights his work in transforming Obesity management through evidence based holistic clinical practice.



Shri Yamunotri



Shri Gangotri



Shri Kedarnath



Shri Badrinath



SPIRITUAL AND NATURAL ATTRACTIONS NEAR THE CHAR DHAM ROUTE

Near Yamunotri

Janki Chatti & Hanuman Chatti, Kharsali Village, Saptarishi Kund, Lakhamandal, Kedarkantha Trek, Rana Chatti.

Near Kedarnath

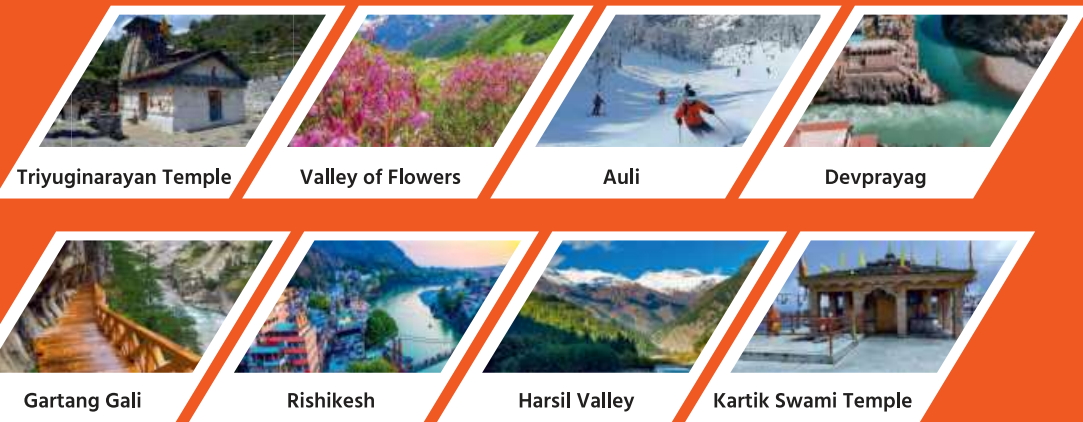
Bhairavnath Temple, Vasuki Tal, Gaurikund, Triyuginarayan Temple, Chopta - Tungnath - Chandra Shila, Deoria Tal.

Near Gangotri

Gaumukh Trek, Bhojbasa & Tapovan, Surya Kund & Gauri Kund, Harsil Valley, Mukhimath (Mukhba), Dayara Bugyal Trek, Gartang Gali, Kashi Vishwanath Temple (Uttarkashi), Nachiketa Tal & Dodital.

Near Badrinath

Mana Village, Vyas Gufa & Ganesh Gufa, Bhimsila, Auli, Valley of Flowers, Vasudhara Falls, Charanpaduka, Tapt Kund & Narad Kund, Jyotirmath (Joshimath), Satopanth Lake, Pandukeshwar, Adibadri Temple, Hemkund Sahib.



“The Honourable Prime Minister has termed the third decade of the 21st century as the 'Decade of Uttarakhand.' In line with the Prime Minister's vision, we are working with an 'unwavering commitment' (Vikalp Rahit Sankalp) to make the state an ideal state in every field.”

Pushkar Singh Dhami
Chief Minister, Uttarakhand

Important Information

- Mandatory Registration:** Registration is compulsory before commencing the Yatra.
- Verify Contact Details:** Please ensure you enter the correct mobile number during registration.
- Be Prepared for Weather:** Carry adequate woolen clothes, an umbrella, and a raincoat.
- Accurate Health Data:** Provide precise health information during the registration process.
- Senior Citizen Advisory:** Senior citizens are advised to undergo a medical check-up before starting the journey.
- Medication:** If you are on prescribed medication, carry a sufficient stock of your medicines.
- Acclimatisation:** Take frequent breaks at various transit points along the route to acclimatize to the high-altitude climate.
- Health First:** If you feel unwell, please do not proceed with the journey.
- Beware of Scams:** Avoid unauthorised individuals claiming to facilitate 'Darshan' at the shrines.
- Keep Tracks Clean:** Cooperate with us in keeping the pilgrimage routes clean; do not litter.
- Safe Driving:** Maintain controlled vehicle speed and park only in designated parking areas.
- No Plastic:** Strictly avoid the use of single-use plastic.

Modes of Registration

Visit the website or scan the QR Code:
registrationandtouristcare.uk.gov.in



Download the App
touristcareuttarakhand



FOR ANY ASSISTANCE:
PLEASE CONTACT OUR 24X7
TOLL FREE NUMBER:
0135-3520100
FOR FURTHER INFORMATION CONTACT
PHONE:
0135-2552627
0135-2559898
E-MAIL:
touristcare.uttarakhand@gmail.com



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Devbhoomi Uttarakhand

VIKAS BHI, VIRASAT BHI

Chardham Yatra

A WARM WELCOME TO ALL DEVOTEES



My dear Countrymen,

The sacred Chardham Yatra has commenced in the holy land of Devbhoomi Uttarakhand. This divine pilgrimage to the four shrines, including the darshan of Baba Kedar, is a magnificent celebration of India's eternal (Sanatan) cultural consciousness. Jagadguru Adi Shankaracharya gave a new direction to Indian culture through his pilgrimages to Badrinath and Kedarnath. Similarly, Jagadguru Ramanujacharya and Jagadguru Madhvacharya also visited Badrinath to enrich their spiritual philosophies.

Even today, these four shrines nestled in the lap of the Himalayas remain divine centers of our eternal faith and belief. Every year, people belonging to diverse languages, traditions, and cultures come here, further strengthening the spirit of 'Ek Bharat, Shreshtha Bharat'. This year's Yatra is an extension of that very tradition.

Our scriptures state:

अग्निहोमादिभिर्यज्ञैरिष्टा विपुलदक्षिणेः।
न तत्फलमवाप्नोति तीर्थभिगमनेन यत्॥

Meaning: The immense merit (Punya) earned through grand Yagyas (sacrificial rituals) and charity is profound. However, the merit obtained through a pilgrimage (Tirtha Yatra) is even greater than that gained through those rituals.

In the resolve for a 'Viksit Bharat' (Developed India), the role of a 'Viksit Uttarakhand' is extremely vital. A few years ago, at the gateway of Baba Kedar, I had said that this decade would be the 'Decade of Uttarakhand.' Today, the progress of Uttarakhand is turning that belief into reality. Uttarakhand is setting new benchmarks in all three sectors: tourism, spirituality, and economic growth.

The great ritual of development (Vikas ka Mahayagya) that has been underway in Uttarakhand for the past few years has made the Chardham Yatra more accessible, safer, and divine than ever before. This is providing great convenience to the visiting devotees, saints, and tourists. In all these efforts, every care is being taken to preserve the natural beauty of Uttarakhand.

I would also urge every guest visiting Uttarakhand to truly enjoy this new experience. During your journey, I encourage all travellers to observe a "Digital Fast" and strive to live within the natural beauty of Uttarakhand. This will provide you with a unique sense of satisfaction.

Historically, we have always traveled from our homes to Devbhoomi for the Chardham Yatra with a specific resolve. In this spirit, I wish to urge you to take Five Resolves (Panch Sankalp):

First Resolve – Cleanliness is Paramount: Maintain cleanliness within and around the shrines. Contribute your part to keeping the rivers clean. Take a pledge for a journey free of single-use plastic and uphold the dignity of this sacred land.

Second Resolve – Sensitivity towards Nature and Environment: Be sensitive toward this divine Himalayan land. While maintaining the balance of nature, contribute to environmental conservation through initiatives like 'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam' (A Tree in Mother's Name).

Third Resolve – Emphasis on Service, Cooperation, and Unity: Since ancient times, our pilgrimages have been a medium for universal service and social harmony. Even today, people serve pilgrims with this same spirit. I urge every pilgrim visiting the Chardham to perform at least one act of service every day of their journey. Help your fellow travellers and connect with people coming from different parts of the country. By participating in their traditions, strengthen the spirit of 'Ek Bharat, Shreshtha Bharat' through this pilgrimage.

Fourth Resolve – Promoting 'Vocal for Local': From the time you leave your home until you return, ensure that you spend at least five percent of your total travel budget on purchasing local products. Even if a local item is not immediately needed in this season, try to buy it for future use.

Fifth Resolve – Adherence to Discipline, Safety, and Decorum: Follow the rules of the journey and traffic instructions. As a responsible and alert citizen, make this pilgrimage safe and accessible. Let us ensure that our journey does not cause any inconvenience to the people involved in the organisation and management of this Yatra.

In recent years, a large number of creators and influencers have started visiting the Chardham. I urge all of you to make an effort to share the local stories of Uttarakhand and its small, unique traditions with the masses.

May the blessings of Baba Kedar and all the four shrines infuse your life with new energy, new inspiration, and new resolutions. This is my wish for you.

My heartiest best wishes to all of you for a successful, safe, divine, and soulful journey.

Yours

Narendra Modi



Panch Kedar

1. Kedarnath
2. Tungnath
3. Rudranath
4. Madhmaheshwar
5. Kalpeswar

Panch Prayag

1. Devprayag
2. Rudraprayag
3. Karnprayag
4. Nandprayag
5. Vishnuprayag

Panch Badri

1. Vishal Badri
2. Yogdarshan Badri
3. Bhavya Badri
4. Vradha Badri
5. Aadi Badri

**Use only the official portal
for Helicopter Bookings
To Avoid any Fraud
www.heliyatra.irttc.co.in**

During the Chardham Yatra, you can also visit and experience the divine Panch Kedar, Panch Prayag and Panch Badri. In the Panch Badri, Lord Vishnu is worshipped in various unique forms



Tamil Nadu

INBRIEF



Announcement of Class XII Board exam results postponed

The announcement of the Tamil Nadu State Board exam results for Class XII has been postponed, officials of the School Education Department said on Wednesday. The results were scheduled to be announced on May 8. Officials of the Directorate of Government Examinations said the results were being processed, and a new date would be announced later. Sources in the department said the announcement of the results had been put off as the new government was yet to be formed. A total of 8,16,289 students had written the Class XII exams, which began on March 2 and ended on March 26.



NTK candidate to plant 6,450 saplings to thank voters

The NTK candidate for Salem (North), M. Gunaseela, who secured 6,450 votes in the recently concluded Assembly election, has announced that she will plant 6,450 saplings as a gesture of gratitude to the voters. She said the saplings would be planted at Mookaneri in Kannankurichi, and along the lake, with the aim of increasing green cover and promoting environmental conservation. She said the planting would be carried out in phases, and arrangements would be made to ensure the saplings' growth. Party functionaries and volunteers would take part in the drive.

After outreach to Cong. and CPI(M), TVK approaches CPI for support

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

TVK president C. Joseph Vijay has reached out to the CPI, a constituent of the DMK-led Secular Progressive Alliance (SPA), seeking its support to form a government.

Speaking to *The Hindu*, CPI State secretary M. Vee- rapandian said the party had received a letter from Mr. Vijay, seeking support. “The party has called for an executive committee meeting on May 8. We will discuss and, if required, we will call for an urgent State committee meeting the next day to take a call on the TVK’s request,” he said.

The CPI had won two seats in the Assembly election. The TVK had already reached out to the Congress and the CPI(M) – both part of the SPA. The Congress had won five seats, and the CPI(M) two.

Since Mr. Vijay has to resign from one of the two constituencies – Perambur and Tiruchi East – from where he was elected, the TVK would effectively have 107 MLAs. This would bring down the strength of the House to 233. The TVK needs the support of 10 more members to get a majority of 117.

Meanwhile, VCK leader Thol. Thirumavalavan said a decision on supporting the TVK would be taken after consulting senior office-bearers. The meeting is likely to be held on Thursday or Friday.

AIADMK sticks to its stand of not extending support to TVK

Deputy general secretary Munusamy dismisses reports of the party’s inclination to support the TVK, after Palaniswami holds a meeting with newly-elected legislators and senior office-bearers

T. Ramakrishnan
CHENNAI

The AIADMK on Wednesday reiterated that it would not support the regime likely to be formed by the TVK.

Stating this after the party general secretary, Edappadi K. Palaniswami, held a meeting with newly-elected legislators and senior office-bearers, its deputy general secretary K.P. Munusamy, in a conversation with *The Hindu*, did not give any lengthy reason for the decision. “Ours is a big institution. This observation explains everything, doesn’t it?” he said, dismissing reports of the party’s inclination to support the TVK.

Notwithstanding his assertion, there were voices within the organisation that wanted to support the government of the fledgling party. On Tuesday, former Finance Minister C. Ponnaiyan told *The Hindu*: “We are an ally of the BJP. How does the question of my party supporting the TVK or taking support from the TVK arise?”

However, later in the day, the tone for the reconsideration of the party’s stand was set by Leema Rose, the newly elected legislator from Lalgudi, who told the media that negotiations were under way between Mr. Palaniswami and the TVK over the formation of the government. When *The Hindu* tried con-



AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami at a meeting with newly-elected MLAs and party office-bearers on Wednesday.

tacting her on Wednesday, she remained incommunicado. On Tuesday, there were also varying reports regarding a meeting between TVK general secretary ‘Bussy’ N. Anand and Mr. Palaniswami.

Since Wednesday morning, sections of the AIADMK have been spreading the word that a large chunk of MLAs-elect was rallying behind former Law Minister C.Ve. Shanmugam, who was elected from Mailam, for the purpose of sharing power in the government. Mr. Shanmugam, who was not accessible to this journalist despite repeated efforts, told reporters that it was for the party to take a call.

Some of the new legislators, including L. Jayasudha and former Ministers K.P. Anbalagan and N. Thalaivi Sundaram, to whom this correspondent spoke, said that when they all met the AIADMK general secretary on Tuesday to exchange pleasantries, there was neither a discussion

on the party’s stand vis-à-vis the likely TVK regime, nor any signature campaign favouring the organisation’s support for the new government.

Mr. Shanmugam’s political stock seems to have gone up in the wake of the party’s abysmal performance in the western belt and moderate showing in the old North Arcot-South Arcot (NASA) region, covering the districts of Vellore, Tirupattur, Ranipet, Tiruvannamalai, Kallakurichi, Cuddalore, and Villupuram. The party, which secured 47 seats across the State, won 16 in the region. Mr. Shanmugam and his colleague, S.P. Velumani, held talks at the former’s residence before meeting Mr. Palaniswami.

There are reports in sections of the media that the BJP is keen on the AIADMK supporting the TVK government to prevent any room for the Congress’s support.

However, some functionaries of the AIADMK

feel that, as their party and the TVK are on the same page with regard to opposing the DMK, they should come together.

Besides, as the Leader of the Opposition post has gone to the DMK, there is no point in trying to find relevance for the party to remain in the Opposition. It would be beneficial for the AIADMK to be “a part of the change” in the government. Such a move will be in sync with the “thinking” of 2.38 crore electors, who are less than 40 years of age and constitute a major chunk of change-makers, some office-bearers say.

There is also a view in the party that, by becoming an ally of the TVK regime, the entire Opposition space will have to be ceded to the DMK as, after all, the TVK has grown, to some extent, at the expense of the AIADMK.

A senior leader of the party in the western region says the TVK’s senior leader and former School Education Minister K.A. Sengottaiyan is in contact with some of the MLAs of the AIADMK, triggering talk that the party is heading towards a split.

AIADMK MLAs in resort Most AIADMK legislators were housed in a resort in Pudukcherry, a senior leader said. According to the leader, the TVK had not formally sought support from the AIADMK to form a government.

‘Congress has adopted BJP’s shortcuts in Tamil Nadu’

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Reacting strongly to the Congress’s decision to unilaterally snap ties with the DMK and align with the TVK, DMK treasurer T. R. Baalu on Wednesday alleged that the national party had adopted “shortcut routes” in Tamil Nadu, similar to those followed by the BJP in several States.

“The Congress can support anyone; it is their right. But political ethics demand that they remain faithful to the people who voted for them,” Mr. Baalu said in a statement.

“Failure is not new to us, nor is betrayal. But neither is permanent. Time will provide the answer,” he added.

Mr. Baalu said the Congress’s statement outlining its political stand had exposed its “true character” which, he claimed, had remained dormant at times. “Whenever the Congress faced a crisis, the DMK, as a faithful friend, stood by it. The price we paid was heavy, but we faced it with a smile,” he said.

Recalling the cordial ties between the DMK leadership and Congress leaders such as Sonia Gandhi, former Prime Minister Manmohan Singh, and Rahul Gandhi, Mr. Baalu said Mr. Gandhi had once reiterated his commitment, saying M.K. Stalin was the only leader he would address as a “brother”.

“But we are not surprised that the relationship has come to an end,” he said. Mr. Baalu said the Congress had “pawned” in a “despicable manner” its five MLAs, who were part of the Secular Progressive Alliance.

The roller-coaster relationship of DMK and Congress finally derails

B. Kolappan
CHENNAI

The over two-decade-old relationship between the DMK and the Congress, with a brief break during the 2014 Lok Sabha polls, has finally come to an end. Whenever the two parties engaged in tough bargaining over seat-sharing – first in 2011, when the Congress insisted on being allotted 90 seats and eventually got over 60, and again in 2026, when negotiations reached a stage of brinkmanship – the alliance ended up losing the election.

Though together, they shaped India’s coalition politics and remained an antidote to the BJP and its ideology, their relationship was not free of tension. In 2004, DMK leader M. Karunanidhi, demanding important portfolios for his party’s Ministers, as agreed in the pre-poll arrangement, announced that they would not assume office until his demands were met. The Congress, then at the mercy of its allies, obliged. However, it stood firm in 2009 and retained the key portfolios. The 2G spectrum issue further widened the divide between the two parties, and the DMK quit the Congress-led government before the 2014 Lok Sabha polls, even though the Congress leadership sent senior leaders, including Pranab Mukherjee, Ghulam Nabi Azad, and A.K. Antony, to placate Mr. Karunanidhi. It was M.K. Stalin who stubbornly refused to entertain the Congress’s plea. The parties, however, came together again in the 2016 Assembly polls.

Lack of options What prevented the Con-



Pulling apart: Though together, the two parties shaped India’s coalition politics and remained an antidote to the BJP and its ideology, the relationship was not free of tension. FILE PHOTO

gress from walking out of the alliance was the long-standing relationship and the emergence of the BJP as a major force at the Centre. It also could not find a suitable ally in Tamil Nadu, as the AIADMK had often taken a soft Hindutva line, and had been more comfortable in the company of the BJP. What was expected to happen in the run-up to the 2016 elections has now occurred after the 2026 elections.

“We were not able to find an appropriate reason to leave the alliance, even though there was a strong opinion in favour of joining the TVK of actor Vijay, since we have sailed together in many elections. We could not say no when Mr. Vijay reached out to us. It is the wish of the majority of the party workers in the State,” said a senior Congress leader, who had opposed snapping ties with the DMK in the 2026 elections.

He added that though there was a good understanding between the leaders of the DMK and the Congress, the treatment meted out to local Congress leaders by DMK functionaries created consider-

able resentment. “They are celebrating the end of the alliance,” he said.

The DMK defeated the Congress in 1967 and consigned it to the margins of Tamil Nadu politics thereafter. The two parties remained mutually antagonistic, with a wide gap between them, especially following the Emergency, when many DMK leaders were incarcerated. The Congress’s hopes of re-emerging in Tamil Nadu politics were further dashed by the emergence of another Dravidian party, the AIADMK, launched by M.G. Ramachandran. Between them, the two parties shared power, leaving little space for the Congress, which was forced to align with one or the other.

Its attempt to revive its fortunes in 1980 failed. The Congress, then headed by the late M.P. Subramaniam, succeeded in persuading Karunanidhi to agree to an equal share of seats and power. However, the plan came a cropper, as the alliance was defeated.

Irrespective of the outcome of the 2026 Assembly elections, the DMK leadership had made up its

mind to snap ties with the Congress after the bitter experience of seat-sharing negotiations. Mr. Stalin was reportedly upset that Congress leader Rahul Gandhi, with whom he believed he shared a close bond, did not reach out during the negotiations. He also failed to share the dais with Mr. Stalin during the campaign. When a suggestion to send winning Congress candidates to meet Mr. Stalin and thank him was turned down, it became clear that the relationship had effectively ended.

Another Congress leader, however, questioned the logic of extending blanket support to Mr. Vijay and contesting alongside him in all future elections, including the Rajya Sabha polls.

“We may have differences with the DMK, but no leader in the country has opposed the BJP in the manner Mr. Stalin has. What will be the Congress’s stand if Mr. Vijay does not show a similar commitment to opposing the BJP,” he asked.

He also pointed out that the emergence of the TVK had disrupted bipolar politics in the State, potentially making things easier for the BJP, which has been waiting for such an opportunity. “A three-cornered contest will eventually weaken one of the Dravidian parties, and may pave the way for the BJP to step in and occupy that space. Even now, the BJP can manoeuvre the situation to its advantage with the help of the Governor. While supporting Mr. Vijay, the Congress cannot afford to allow any compromise in its stand against the BJP,” he said.

Plea in HC seeks FIR, money laundering probe against Vijay over 2015 tax dispute

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

A writ petition has been filed in the Madras High Court, seeking registration of a First Information Report (FIR) against Tamilaga Vетtri Kazhagam (TVK) president C. Joseph Vijay on the basis of income tax proceedings initiated after the release of his Tamil movie *Puli* in 2015 for alleged suppression of income, receipt of unaccounted cash remuneration, and concealment of financial transactions.

The High Court Registry numbered the writ petition on Wednesday, and it is expected to be listed under the caption, ‘For Maintainability’, shortly. Though the case was filed on March 18 this year, the Registry had refused to number the case. However, the first Division Bench of Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dhar-madhikari and Justice G. Arul Murugan, on April 8, directed the Registry to number it, subject to maintainability.

The Income Tax Department had conducted a search-and-seizure operation on a premises belonging to Mr. Vijay on September 30, 2015, and seized certain incriminating materials. The materials indicated that P.T. Selvakumar and Shibu of SKT Studios, the producers of *Puli*, had paid him ₹4.93 crore in cash, apart from the remuneration of ₹16 crore through cheques.

The producers had deposited the Tax Deducted at Source (TDS) only for the cheque amount, and not the cash transaction. When Mr. Vijay was con-



C. Joseph Vijay

The case pertains to alleged suppression of income, receipt of unaccounted cash remuneration, and concealment of financial transactions

fronted with the records, he reportedly admitted to having received ₹5 crore in cash, and agreed to pay the tax on it. When asked how much of unaccounted income he had earned in the last six years, he replied that he hadn’t received any unaccounted cash but for the ₹5 crore for *Puli*.

Additional income Nevertheless, to cooperate with the I-T Department and resolve the tax issues in an amicable manner, Mr. Vijay had agreed to disclose an additional income of ₹15 crore (including the cash transaction of ₹5 crore) for the financial year 2015-16, and pay the necessary tax on it.

Subsequently, on July 29, 2016, he filed his return of income for the assessment year 2016-17, declaring his total income to be ₹35.42 crore, including the additional ₹15 crore. While filing the returns, he claimed depreciation of assets worth ₹17.81 lakh, and sought an exemption for

Should Cong. stand with ‘those rejected by the people’, asks party MP

The Hindu Bureau
MADURAI/TIRUCHI

Congress MP B. Manickam Tagore, who was among those in the party pushing for an alliance with the TVK before the Assembly election, on Wednesday said the people of the State had rejected the M.K. Stalin-led DMK.

In a social media post, he said the Tamil Nadu election results “have gone against the DMK”. The Virudhunagar MP ridiculed the Dravidian party, claiming that half of the DMK’s Cabinet Ministers had lost their seats in the election. He further said the Congress had won only five out of the 28 seats it had contested as part of the DMK-led Secular Progressive Alliance (SPA), and claimed that the national party had faced collateral damage “for no fault of ours”.

Claiming that the ruling BJP at the Centre was eyeing Tamil Nadu, Mr. Tagore said the question before the Congress was clear: “Should we stand with those rejected by the people’s verdict, or should we unite with the force that fought against the BJP and will fight to stop the BJP from ruling Tamil Nadu?”

Meanwhile, Karur MP S. Jothimani said the Congress and the DMK should part ways with mutual respect, avoiding harsh criticisms against each other, in the wake of the national party’s decision to support the TVK.



D.N. Jeevara, MLA, being greeted by Speaker U.T. Khader on Wednesday. SUDHAKARA JAIN

Karnataka BJP leader takes oath as MLA after recount

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU/MANGALURU

Karnataka BJP leader D.N. Jeevaraj was sworn in as MLA on Wednesday, following a recount held three years after the Assembly election.

Assembly Speaker U.T. Khader administered the oath of office to him.

Mr. Jeevaraj had lost to Congress' T.D. Raje Gowda in the 2023 election from the Sringeri Assembly constituency. Following a recount of postal ballots polled in 2023, as directed by the High Court of Karnataka, he was declared elected from the seat, setting off a controversy.

The Congress accused the BJP of a "criminal conspiracy" and asked how 255 valid votes polled in favour of Mr. Gowda were declared invalid in the recount. An FIR has been registered against Mr. Jeevaraj for allegedly tampering with postal ballots.

The BJP earlier accused Mr. Khader of "intentionally" delaying the oath-taking of Mr. Jeevaraj and sought the Governor's intervention. Denying the charges, Mr. Khader said the circumstances of Mr. Jeevaraj's election were unique and hence he would have to study the legal aspects. However, hours later, he rushed to Bengaluru and administered the oath.

Kerala CPI(M) to take feedback on poll rout from all party members

It will provide platform to cadres at all levels to voice their criticism 'fearlessly'; State secretary admits to organisational issues and says party will corrective steps to win back people's trust; CPI members criticise Pinarayi's style of functioning

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Jolted by one of the biggest defeats in its electoral history, the CPI(M) in Kerala has decided to hold meetings at all levels to allow party members to voice their criticism and opinions "fearlessly."

After a meeting of the party's State secretariat here on Wednesday, CPI (M) State secretary M.V. Govindan told mediapersons that the State leadership will conduct a review and take corrective measures to win back the confidence of the people.

The decision to provide a platform for party mem-



People's script: A hoarding that reads 'Bye, Bye Pinarayi' was put up by an association in Thiruvananthapuram after the results. PTI

bers down to the branch committee level to express their opinion comes in the wake of the crushing defeat of the party even in

some of its strongholds in Kannur.

Mr. Govindan said the State secretariat had carried out only a preliminary

assessment of the causes of the defeat. A detailed analysis will be done at all levels of the party.

"The party understands that there have been organisational and political issues as well as negative propaganda against the party, which contributed to the defeat.. The Left has a history of learning from setbacks and taking corrective steps to make a comeback. We will make an honest assessment," he said.

Review meetings

It will hold meetings of party committees at various levels. "All the comrades across all levels will have the opportunity to raise is-

sues freely and fearlessly. The party's election review will be prepared based on the discussions in these meetings, instead of the State secretariat preparing a review and passing it to lower levels," said Mr. Govindan.

The CPI too will hold meetings in all districts to assess the party's performance. At a party meeting on Wednesday, members criticised the style of functioning of outgoing Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan. "Changes will be made wherever it is needed. What needs to be corrected will be corrected," party State secretary Binoy Viswam said.

Sabarimala review: SC questions validity of PIL against 1962 order

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Wednesday questioned the maintainability of public interest litigation (PIL) or writ petitions challenging the authority of the Dawoodi Bohra community leaders to excommunicate their members.

In 2023, the court had referred to a nine-judge Bench for an authoritative pronouncement on whether the practice of excommunication among the Dawoodi Bohras could continue as a "protected practice" despite the coming into force of the Maharashtra Protection of People from Social Boycott (Prevention, Prohibition

and Redressal) Act of 2016.

The petitions had challenged a 1962 judgment of a five-judge Constitution Bench in the *Sardar Syedna Taher Saifuddin vs The State Of Bombay* case. The reference to the Dawoodi Bohra was later tagged with the Sabarimala case.

On Wednesday, Justice B.V. Nagarathna, a member of the nine-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, asked senior advocate Raju Ramachandran, appearing for the writ petitioners, if a Constitution Bench judgment, that too one which had held the fort for over 60 years, could be challenged through PILs, however "reformist" they may intend to be.

A.P. govt. dismisses 51 doctors for long absence

The Hindu Bureau
VIJAYAWADA

Citing long absence from duty, the Andhra Pradesh government has dismissed 51 doctors of teaching hospitals under the purview of the Directorate of Medical Education (DME), Health Minister Satya Kumar Yadav said on Wednesday.

A release from the Health Department said 41 of them were Assistant Professors, eight were Associate Professors and two tutors. The Minister said the government had earlier issued show-cause notices to the doctors and given them a chance to explain themselves. However, they failed to respond, he said.

4 farmers die in shed collapse in Telangana

The Hindu Bureau
MANCHERIAL

Four farmers died after sheds collapsed on them at a paddy procurement centre in Mancherial district of Telangana on Wednesday. Four injured farmers were hospitalised.

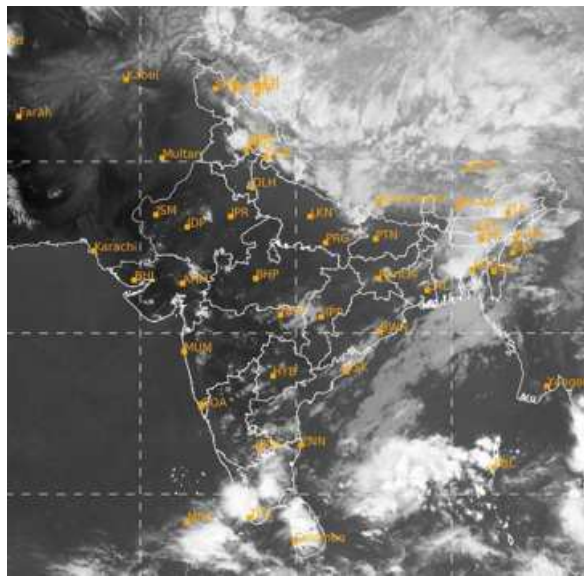
Owing to gusty winds in the region, farmers had gathered at the procurement centre located between Kothur and Gampalpalli villages to cover grain heaps with tarpaulins,

sources said. As the winds picked up, the farmers moved closer to nearby structures for shelter, when the tin-roofed sheds collapsed on them.

BRS working president K.T. Rama Rao expressed condolences and sought ₹25 lakh ex gratia for the families of the deceased. Criticising the government over the delay in procurement, he said farmers were being forced to guard their produce at the centres for prolonged periods.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 17.45 HRS)

Forecast for Thursday: Heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry and Kerala. Thunderstorm with lightning & gusty winds likely at isolated places over Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura, Sikkim, Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh and Andaman & Nicobar Islands

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala		31.9	23.4	Kozhikode		35.9	25.4
Ahmedabad		40.2	28.0	Kurnool		39.5	28.1
Aizawl		31.9	17.2	Lucknow		33.3	21.0
Allahabad		35.4	20.6	Madurai		36.0	22.6
Bengaluru		32.9	22.0	Mangaluru		35.0	24.0
Bhopal		37.2	21.4	Mumbai		33.9	25.3
Bhubaneswar		36.1	22.8	Mysuru		35.0	21.0
Chandigarh		34.3	18.0	New Delhi		35.4	20.7
Chennai		36.6	28.6	Patna		33.4	24.3
Coimbatore		36.8	24.4	Port Blair		33.7	25.7
Dehradun		31.7	16.2	Puducherry		37.1	22.2
Gangtok		17.1	16.6	Pune		40.2	24.5
Goa		36.5	27.4	Raipur		37.1	22.2
Guwahati		33.1	23.3	Ranchi		32.0	20.0
Hubballi		38.0	23.0	Shillong		22.4	12.9
Hyderabad		36.5	25.6	Shimla		18.1	9.0
Imphal		31.0	19.3	Srinagar		25.1	8.3
Jaipur		36.6	24.6	Thiruvananthapuram		37.0	27.1
Kochi		32.6	27.2	Tiruchi		36.6	26.4
Kohima		24.0	15.0	Vijayawada		36.6	28.4
Kolkata		34.1	26.1	Visakhapatnam		33.9	25.0

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM _{2.5}	PM ₁₀	CODE	Yesterday
Ahmedabad		19	18	53	147	135	In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Sri
Bengaluru		1	—	47	151	148	Ganganagar, Rajasthan
Chennai		10	16	36	37	52	recorded an overall air
Delhi		29	63	92	171	169	quality index (AQI) score
Hyderabad		20	22	15	65	98	of 274 indicating an
Kolkata		8	57	21	40	47	unhealthy level of
Lucknow		11	9	41	168	101	pollution. In contrast,
Mumbai		13	106	15	48	72	Madikeri, Karnataka
Pune		23	123	41	40	75	recorded a healthy AQI
Visakhapatnam		11	29	14	24	63	score of 25

Air Quality Code: ■ Poor ■ Moderate ■ Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

OBITUARY



We deeply mourn the demise of **V. Suresh Kumar Reddy** (82 Years) Passed away on 06th May 2026 at Chennai.

Mourning by Radhika, Swetha, Smitha, sons-in-law, grandchildren, brothers and family.

Residence Address: No 234/278, B3, JJ Road, Alwarpet, Chennai - 600018

DEATH

SHRADANJALI



Our dearest sister **Pushpa @ N. LAKSHMI** passed away on 6th May. The memories u have left shall be remembered always, dear Pushpa. None can replace you. Inserted by: **Mohan and Brothers Family**

VISHAL ENTERPRISES Nacharam, Hyderabad

HOMAGE

HOMAGE



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NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

DRM(S&T) NWR, Ajmer on behalf of the President of India invites E-Tender for the following work up to 15.00 Hrs. on the mentioned date. **Tender No.:-** DRM-S&T-14-2026-27. **Name of Work:- Ajmer Division:-** Providing Design, manufacture, supply, installation, testing and commissioning of Electronic Interlocking (EI) systems along with execution of indoor and outdoor complete MACLS work with Std-III to suit RE standards at Khemli station in C/W Development of common user facility for line no. 4 at Khemli (KLH) station, CONCOR siding and development of rail siding (UCWL) at Khemli (KLH) station in Ajmer Division of NWR. **Approximate cost of work:-** Rs. 73394402.33. **Bid security:-** Rs. 1467900.00. **Date & Time of opening E-Tender -** 01.06.2026 at 15.30 Hrs. The details of above E-Tender are available on website **www.ireps.gov.in**. **662-DO/26**
Please join us on f    **NWR/Railways**

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Tender Notice No. RWF/S/03/2026-27
Dated: 05/05/2026

On behalf of the President of India, the Principal Chief Materials Manager invites Electronic Open Tender from supply of the following two items, on the Indian Railways e-portal www.ireps.gov.in. **Sl. No.:** 1. **Tender No.:** P2265302A. **Brief Item Description:** Replacement of 2 nos. of 400 KVA Transformers with 2 nos. Transformer of 500 KVA capacity and LT switch gear panel with associated works for Canteen substation as per Specification No.R WFE/EL/P/2025-26/06. **Quantity:** 1 Set. **Tender Closing Date and Time:** 18/05/2026 14:00 hrs. **Sl. No.:** 2. **Tender No.:** P2265192. **Brief Item Description:** Design, Manufacture, Supply, Erection, Testing and Commissioning of 5 Ton EOT crane for extension of wheelset stacking area of assembly as per RWF Technical Specification No.RWF/M&P/ASSY/2025/5 T EOT crane. **Quantity:** 2 Nos. **Tender Closing Date and Time:** 28/05/2026 14:00 hrs. **Pre-bid date** 12/05/2026 15:00 hrs. **Tender corrigendum** can be viewed on our website www.rwf.indianrailways.gov.in or www.ireps.gov.in. The tender documents, Specification and the corrigendum to the Tender will be available on the portal only. **Principal Chief Materials Manager**

SOUTHERN RAILWAY

CONSTRUCTION ORGANIZATION

GeM Bid No. GEM/2026/B/7478954 Dated: 27.04.2026

Name of Work					
1.Manpower Outsourcing Services - Officer's Rest House @ Trichy, Mayiladuthurai, Pattukkottai, Karaikkal, Construction Stores Depot / Ponnmalai, Main Gate and Camp office of Deputy Chief Engineer, Gauge Conversion, Trichy.					
Sl. No.	App Cash value (in ₹)	Earnest Money Deposit (in ₹)	Period of completion in months	Bid End Date / Time	Opening date / Time
1	1,43,55,345.89	2,21,800.00*	Twenty Four (24)	21.00 hrs on 07.05.2026	21.30 hrs on 07.05.2026

*Corrigendum issued vide GEM/2026/B/7478954-C1 dated 28.04.2026

Deputy Chief Engineer / Gauge Conversion / II / Tiruchchirappalli

ଓଡ଼ିଶା ବିଦ୍ୟୁତ୍ ଶକ୍ତି ସଂଚାରଣ ନିଗମ ଲିଡ଼

(ଓଡ଼ିଶା ସରକାରଙ୍କ ଏକ ଉପକ୍ରମ)



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NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

E-Tender No.	Tender Description:	Estimated Cost
CPC-03/2026-27	Bid invited from reputed bidders in single stage two part bidding system for Selection of agency for providing the services of skilled/high-skilled manpower for various maintenance works of Grid Sub-Stations and transmission lines of OPTCL in four(04) Lots in e-tendering mode only.	
	LOT-1: Central (O&M) Zone, BBSR	Rs. 3,22,45,944/-
	LOT-2: Northern (O&M) Zone, Balasore	Rs. 2,51,86,635/-
	LOT-3: Southern (O&M) Zone, Berhampur	Rs. 2,17,11,036/-
	LOT-4: Western (O&M) Zone, Burla	Rs. 2,77,57,425/-
	Last Date & Time of Submission of Bid:	05.06.2026 upto 17:30 P.M.

Complete set of bidding documents are available at www.tenderwizard.com/OPTCL and www.optcl.co.in.

s/d
Chief General Manager (CPC)

HIPR-10/2026-27

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A new roadmap for independent cinema

The latest rule changes by the Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences are not merely procedural – they signal a philosophical shift in how global cinema is seen, validated, and circulated. By loosening the “one country, one film” submission rule for the International Feature category, and allowing festival-acclaimed films to qualify independently, the Academy Awards are attempting to dismantle one of the most enduring bottlenecks in world cinema. For India, this is not just an administrative tweak – it is a structural opening, especially for its vibrant but sidelined independent film ecosystem.

For decades, India’s Oscar journey has been shaped as much by internal gatekeeping as by external perception. The country’s official entry – decided by committees – has often sparked debate, with selections that leaned toward middle-of-the-road narratives rather than daring or politically nuanced cinema. This has meant that some of India’s most globally resonant films never even entered the Oscar race.

No dearth of candidates
Consider *The Lunchbox*. Directed by Ritesh Batra, the film premiered at Cannes Critics’ Week; garnered universal acclaim; and travelled widely across international festivals. Its delicate storytelling, anchored in loneliness and urban alienation, spoke a cinematic language that global audiences immediately embraced. Yet, it was not selected as India’s official Oscar entry. Under the new rules, a film like *The Lunchbox* could have bypassed national selection and entered the Oscars directly.

Similarly, *Court* by Chaitanya Tamhane, which is a deeply political examination of India’s judicial system, won the Orizzonti Award at Venice and multiple international honours. While it was India’s official entry, it lacked the sustained campaign



Vani Tripathi Tikoo
Actor, Producer, and the Artistic Director of the International Film Festival of Delhi

For Indian filmmakers, especially those outside the mainstream industry, the Oscars are no longer a distant, opaque institution mediated by national selection

infrastructure to penetrate the Oscar shortlist. Under a system that values festival recognition more directly, such films gain not just eligibility but also legitimacy.

Or take *Masaan*, directed by Neeraj Ghaywan. Premiering in the ‘Un Certain Regard’ section at Cannes and winning two awards, *Masaan* bridged the spaces of the intimate and the universal with remarkable ease. Its exploration of caste, grief, and aspiration in small-town India resonated far beyond its geography. Yet, it never became India’s Oscar entry. In the new framework, its festival success alone could have propelled it into the awards race.

Even more telling are films such as *Village Rockstars* by Rima Das. A deeply personal, almost handmade film set in rural Assam, it won the National Award and travelled internationally, embodying a kind of authenticity that the global film community increasingly values. While it was India’s official submission, its lack of campaign backing limited its reach. A festival-driven qualification system could amplify such voices, allowing them to compete on artistic merit rather than industrial muscle.

Lack of representation
Indian independent cinema has long been globally visible but institutionally underrepresented. The new Oscar guidelines disrupt this pattern by shifting the axis of validation from national committees to international circuits. This is particularly significant in a country like India, where cinema operates across multiple languages, regions, and aesthetic traditions. The idea that a single film can “represent” such diversity has always been flawed. By allowing multiple entry points, the Academy is acknowledging that cinema is not a monolith but a mosaic. However, this expanded access also introduces new complexities. Festival success, while crucial, is not a guarantee of Oscar traction. The Academy’s ecosystem still relies heavily on

visibility, campaigning, and industry networks. Films such as *All We Imagine as Light* by Payal Kapadia demonstrate how crucial sustained global engagement is. Under the new rules, such films are better positioned, but they still require strategic backing to convert acclaim into nominations.

Yet, the broader implication of these changes lies in how they reshape cinematic aspiration. For Indian filmmakers, especially those outside the mainstream industry, the Oscars are no longer a distant, opaque institution mediated by national selection. They become a more accessible platform – one that rewards global dialogue over domestic endorsement. This could catalyse a shift in how films are conceived, produced, and circulated. One may see greater emphasis on international co-productions, festival strategies, and cross-cultural storytelling. At the same time, there is a risk of homogenisation – of films tailoring themselves to perceived “festival tastes” at the expense of local specificity.

But the history of cinema suggests otherwise. The most globally successful films are often those most deeply rooted in their own contexts. Bong Joon-ho’s *Parasite* did not dilute its Korean identity to achieve global success. The lesson for Indian cinema is clear: authenticity travels.

The road ahead
Ultimately, the new Oscar guidelines acknowledge that cinema today is transnational – not because it erases borders, but because it speaks across them.

For Indian independent cinema, this is a moment of possibility. The challenge lies in building the ecosystems that can support this transition: better international distribution, and robust campaign infrastructures. If that happens, the impact could be profound. Not just in terms of awards, but in how Indian stories are positioned within the global cinematic imagination.

The rise of an apolitical polity

TVK’s victory points to the importance of alternative modes of outreach

STATE OF PLAY

B. Kolappan
kolappan.b@thehindu.co.in



Even though Tamil Nadu’s outgoing Chief Minister M. K. Stalin put on a brave face and said he would face both defeat and success with equanimity, his loss in the Kolathur constituency appears to have shaken him. As the leader of the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK), he campaigned across the State for his party, and had been confident that his own constituency was secure, having nurtured it like no other. He will go down in history as the fourth sitting Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu who has lost an election.

Constituencies represented by a Chief Minister typically attain VIP status by default. Kolathur, however, became Mr. Stalin’s second home, as he made it a point to visit almost every week. The constituency saw the development of hospitals, schools, flyovers, playgrounds, and colleges, among other facilities.

Yet voters chose the candidate of the fledgling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK), V. S. Babu, a former DMK leader and district secretary. Observers point to a shift in voting patterns among certain communities in the constituency, including Christians and Scheduled Castes, some of whom appeared to favour actor C. Joseph Vijay’s TVK.

peared to be a shift in preferences. The decline in vote share for the DMK and its allies in districts such as Kanniyakumari, which has a substantial Christian population, suggests the alliance may have lost ground among these voters. In Killiyur, Congress candidate Rajesh Kumar, who had won by a margin of over 50,000 votes in 2021, saw his victory margin shrink to just over 1,000 votes this time. Other constituencies in the district witnessed a similar trend. A comparable pattern appeared in Kolathur, where some voters seemed to favour Mr. Vijay over Mr. Stalin, despite the Chief Minister’s continued engagement with the community, including organising annual Christmas events and extending financial support to certain churches.

Some voters framed their preferences in identity terms, expressing a desire for greater representation in leadership.

leges, and even where they exist, they are often largely apolitical in character. The proliferation of engineering and professional colleges, along with a shift away from the humanities, has further contributed to the weakening of political engagement among students. For many students, the primary focus is on securing employment through campus placements, leaving limited space for sustained political involvement. The DMK leadership appears to be continuing to rely on an older political idiom, rooted in the rhetoric of the 1950s and 1960s, and often centred on emotive appeals, which may have limited resonance in today’s social media-driven campaign environment.

In contrast, Mr. Vijay’s campaign suggests that electoral success can, at least in certain contexts, be achieved without a deeply entrenched organisational structure or continuous engagement through traditional media, large-scale conferences, or expansive campaign spending. His approach points to the growing importance of alternative modes of outreach, particularly those that connect more directly with younger and digitally engaged voters. In many constituencies, voters did not know the candidates of Mr. Vijay’s party. They voted for him and his symbol, the ‘Whistle’.

Mr. Vijay’s victory has put an end to the bipolar politics of Tamil Nadu, hitherto dominated by the two Dravidian parties. The shift towards a three-cornered contest has created space for smaller parties as well as a party like the BJP, which has been making sustained efforts to establish a foothold. The TVK’s emergence may realign Tamil Nadu’s political equations more broadly.

Apolitical Gen-Z

Beyond Kolathur, the DMK appeared to be struggling to connect with sections of ‘Generation Z’ or Gen-Z, whose political engagement tends to be more fluid and less tied to established party structures. Historically, the Dravidian movement has drawn significant strength from student mobilisation. In contrast, campus politics today appears far more subdued. Student unions are absent in many col-

TVK makes inroads into AIADMK’s core voter base in T.N.

Historical floors show the DMK losing less of its core support and more of its floating votes

DATA POINT

Pon Vasanth B.A.
Sambavi Parthasarathy
Srinivasan Ramani

The Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK), which sprung a surprise in the 2026 Assembly elections, has not only altered the bipolar nature of Tamil Nadu’s politics for the first time since 1977, but has also raised questions over the future of the two Dravidian majors – the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) and the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK).

However, analysis of region-wise variations in the vote shares secured by the TVK, the DMK and the AIADMK in the 134 constituencies they directly faced each other showed that the electoral outcome has become an existential threat for the AIADMK, which seems to have lost its core vote bank to the TVK. In contrast, the DMK has largely retained its core vote bank.

In three of the five regions – Greater Chennai, central and south – the vote share secured by the AIADMK in the seats it contested is the lowest in 2026. For the DMK, the vote share secured in 2026 was its lowest ever only in the Greater Chennai region (**Table 1**).

A closer analysis also showed that there was a strong negative correlation between the vote shares secured by the AIADMK and the TVK in almost all of these 134 constituencies (**Table 2**). This means that wherever the AIADMK’s vote share dropped, the TVK’s vote share went up. This was more pronounced in the constituencies in the central and south regions (**Chart 1**).

This negative correlation between the AIADMK and the TVK was robust across all regions, except the West, which had been a stronghold of the former in the past few decades.

In comparison, such a correlation was not observed between the

TVK and the DMK, except in the Greater Chennai region where the TVK swept the polls by hurting both the Dravidian parties. In fact, in the north, central and west regions, both the DMK and the TVK had a positive correlation, which means wherever the TVK had good vote shares or lower ones, the DMK had the same as well.

Curiously, if the AIADMK had lost a chunk of structural or core support to the TVK, then the DMK should have emerged victorious overall, thanks to the split in the anti-incumbency votes. But that did not happen. The reason is visible in another set of data: the change in vote shares since 2021. **Table 3** shows the swing in those same 134 seats.

In most regions, the DMK lost a higher share of votes than the AIADMK – except in the west and the south. And overall, across these 134 seats, the DMK’s vote share dropped by 13.9 percentage points against the AIADMK’s 12.0.

This seeming contradiction where the AIADMK is hitting its lowest floors while the DMK is witnessing a larger overall swing compared to 2021, is best explained by the kinds of voters each party lost. The DMK shed a bigger pool of floating/swing voters to the TVK, either due to anti-incumbency or a clear preference for a new filmstar-led party that promised change. These losses were broadly uniform across constituencies, which is why they show up as a large swing but do not correlate with the TVK’s seat-by-seat strength. The AIADMK lost a smaller share of votes overall because it had a lower vote share than the DMK to begin with in 2021. But a larger fraction of what it lost was core support.

In a party system, where the AIADMK’s political identity rests on it being the anti-DMK pole, the TVK’s inroads into the “Two leaves” base poses a serious threat to the party founded by former Chief Minister M.G. Ramachandran.

Breaching the AIADMK firewall

Only 134 constituencies in which the DMK, the AIADMK and the TVK directly contested against each other in 2026 were considered so that patterns measure transfers between these parties alone and controls for coalition effect

TABLE 1: Years in which the DMK and the AIADMK hit their lowest vote share in the constituencies where they directly contested against each other (*floor refers to the lowest vote share secured by the party)

Region	DMK’s floor* year	DMK’s voteshare in that year (%)	AIADMK’s floor year	AIADMK’s voteshare in that year (%)
Central	1977	29.08	2026	30.03
Greater Chennai	2026	30.8	2026	20.25
North	1991	26.93	1989	27.54
South	1977	18.14	2026	23.19
West	1977	20.39	1996	32.18
All regions	134	-0.75	-0.09	-13.9

TABLE 2: Correlation coefficients (-1 to +1) between parties’ vote shares shows higher -ve values for TVK vs AIADMK

Region	Constituencies	TVK vs AIADMK	TVK vs DMK
Greater Chennai	22	-0.63	-0.32
North	23	-0.69	0.04
Central	26	-0.77	0.04
West	34	-0.58	-0.43
South	29	-0.73	0.02
All Regions	134	-0.75	-0.09

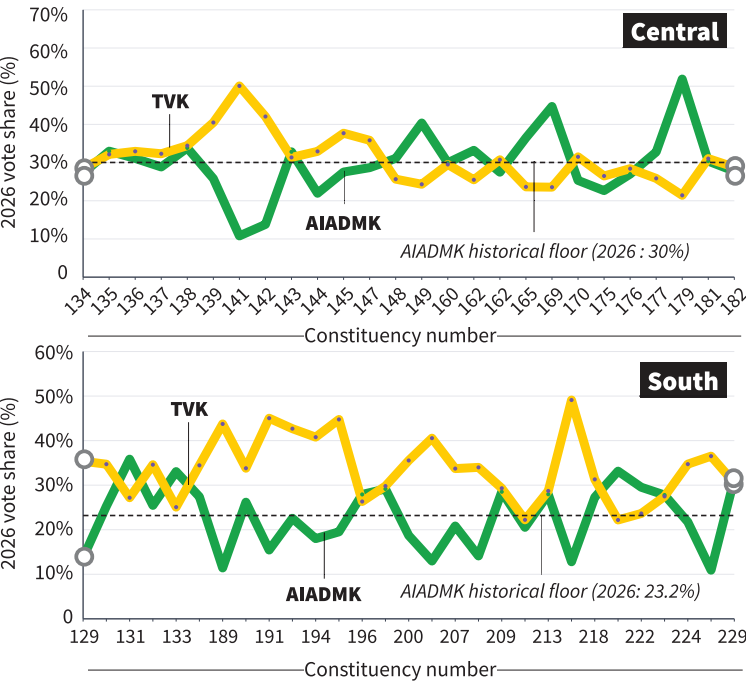
Wherever the AIADMK’s vote shares fell, the TVK’s rose

TABLE 3: The regionwise drop in vote share (in % points) of DMK and AIADMK between 2021 and 2026

Region	DMK	AIADMK
Greater Chennai	-14.9%	-9.7%
North	-19.3%	-12.3%
Central	-16.4%	-8.5%
West	-9.6%	-14.3%
South	-11.6%	-13.9%
All regions	-13.9%	-12.0%

Data sourced from ECI

CHART 1: Vote share secured by the TVK and AIADMK across constituencies where the three parties were in direct contest in the Central and southern region. The graphs show a negative correlation



Campaign fever: TVK flags spotted at an AIADMK rally in Namakkal district as part of its Statewide Makkalai Kappom Thamizhagathai Meetpom campaign in October 2025. LAKSHMI NARAYANAN E

FROM THE ARCHIVES

The **Hindu.**

FIFTY YEARS AGO MAY 7, 1976

Better coffee yields with honey bees

A special experiment conducted by the bee-keeping wing of the Khadi and Village Industries Board in collaboration with the Central Bee Research Institute, Poona, during the blossoming of the coffee plants in Yercaud last month has proved to be a success.

During the one-week period of the experiment when coffee plants were in full blossom it was found that the honey production doubled. In 12 bee-hives kept at selected places, it was found that the average yield from each box was 3 kg as against about 4 kg during normal times.

Special steps were taken to enclose a portion of the coffee plants completely secure from pollination by bees or other natural agents ensuring only self-pollination; in another section coffee plants were allowed to be pollinated by all natural agents including bees, and in the last section coffee plants were surrounded by bee-hives so as to ensure maximum pollination by bees.

The Coffee Research Department is also taking follow-up action to find out the quality and quantity of coffee seeds that would be available from each of these sections after about nine months.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO MAY 7, 1926

Plague’s heavy toll in the Punjab

Simla, May 5: Plague has now assumed alarming proportions in the Punjab. During the week ending 10th April, there were no less than 7,236 cases and deaths stood at 5,379.

Practically every district in the Punjab has some area affected by plague with the exception of Simla, Kangra, Shahpur, Jhelum, Jhang, Multan and Muzaffargarh. The largest number of cases and deaths are reported from the Eastern districts.

Practically all the districts also report stray cases of small-pox. During the week, 365 cases of small pox occurred and 120 were deaths therefrom.

Balaspuri States are reported to be free from infection. The Health Department, Punjab is organising a campaign for meeting this situation.

First BJP govt. in West Bengal will be sworn in on Saturday

BJP Legislature Party meeting will be held tomorrow; Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Union Minister Amit Shah and several Chief Ministers of NDA-ruled States will be present at the event; Sovandeb Chattopadhyay likely to be the Opposition leader

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

The Chief Minister and a few members of the Council of Ministers of the first Bharatiya Janata Party government in West Bengal will be sworn in on Saturday.

The day is considered auspicious in the Bengali calendar. *Pachise Baishak* (25th day of the Bengali month of Baishak) is celebrated across the State, as it marks the birth anniversary of Nobel laureate Rabindranath Tagore.

West Bengal BJP president Samik Bhattacharya told presspersons that a meeting of BJP MLAs-elect will be held on Friday. The BJP government will be sworn in the next day, he said.

“The meeting of BJP legislators-elect will be held at 4 p.m. on May 8. The new BJP government will take oath at 10 a.m. on May 9 at Brigade Parade Ground,” Mr. Bhattacharya announced on Wednesday.

He said Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Union Home Minister Amit Shah and several Chief Ministers from BJP and National Democratic Alliance-ruled States are expected to be present during the cere-



Setting up: Preparation under way at the Brigade Parade Ground in Kolkata for the oath-taking ceremony of the new West Bengal Ministry. ANI

Suvendu says he will follow the directions of BJP leadership; party to say which of his seats to retain

mony. Mr. Bhattacharya also visited the State Secretariat, Nabanna, and discussed arrangements for the swearing-in with the Chief Secretary.

With the BJP securing 207 of the 293 Assembly seats that went to the polls, all eyes are on who will be

sworn in as the next Chief Minister of the State.

BJP leader Suvendu Adhikari, who defeated Trinamool Congress chairperson Mamata Banerjee in Bhabanipur, described himself as a “disciplined” worker of the party.

He said he would follow the directions of the party leadership. Mr. Adhikari added the party would take a call on which of the two seats he won – Bhabanipur and Nandigram – he would retain.

Alongside speculation

over the post of the Chief Minister, there are talks in the party on ministerial berths. Senior BJP leader Dilip Ghosh, former Rajya Sabha member Swapan Dasgupta, Siliguri MLA Sankar Ghosh, prominent woman face Agnimitra Pal, and the party’s senior-most leader, Tapas Roy, are among the top contenders.

Meanwhile, newly elected Trinamool Congress members held a meeting at party supremo Mamata Banerjee’s residence, with senior-most party leader So-

vandeb Chattopadhyay likely to be appointed the Leader of the Opposition.

During the day, West Bengal Chief Electoral Officer Manoj Kumar Agarwal met Governor R.N. Ravi at the Lok Bhavan to complete the statutory formalities of handing over the Gazette notification containing names of elected members of the new Assembly.

On security deployment

In a separate development, additional police deployment and area security arrangements outside the residences of Mamata Banerjee and Abhishek Banerjee at Harish Chatterjee Street and Harish Mukherjee Road, respectively, were withdrawn following a review, though their existing security categorisation remains unchanged.

Senior officials of the Kolkata Police and the West Bengal police said that both Ms. Banerjee and Mr. Banerjee would continue to get police protection.

“In accordance with the ‘Yellow Book’ protocol, the former Chief Minister will be accorded Z-Plus category security,” West Bengal Director-General of Police Siddh Nath Gupta said.

Voices of dissent emerge in Trinamool as leaders blame IPAC, ticket choices

Shrabana Chatterjee
KOLKATA

In the wake of defeat in the Assembly election, voices of dissent have surfaced within the Trinamool Congress, with some leaders blaming political consultancy firm Indian Political Action Committee and the party’s functioning for the electoral setback.

Trinamool’s outgoing Rajganj MLA Khageswar Roy blamed the IPAC for the party’s defeat. “We had to go according to the IPAC’s instructions. The IPAC played a major role in who got ticket in the election. The party and the IPAC together caused this massive defeat,” Mr. Roy said.

Athlete Swapna Barman had replaced Mr. Roy as the Trinamool candidate from Rajganj, though he won in 2021. He said that Ms. Barman’s lack of political experience led to her loss from a seat where the Trinamool had won four times in the past.

He said no local leaders were consulted by the party or the IPAC before changing candidates, which led to the defeat.

Former Trinamool MLA and district president Sourav Chakraborty expressed frustration regarding the party’s performance and



Big change: Security has been scaled down at outgoing Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee’s residence in Kolkata. PTI

internal strategy after the poll setback.

“This is bad candidate selection. Everyone loves and trusts *Didi* [Trinamool chairperson Mamata Banerjee]. New people were brought in by the IPAC,” Mr. Chakraborty said. He also added that the party needs to rethink its strategy and relationship with the IPAC for some real change.

Minister quits party

Another outgoing Trinamool MLA and Minister of State for Sports and Youth Affairs, former Indian cricketer Manoj Tiwary, quit the party soon after its loss alleging corruption within the ranks. “*Paap baap keo chare na* [Sins do

not spare even the father],” Mr. Tiwary posted on social media.

“I faced multiple obstacles at every step while trying to do my work in the last five years... [former Sports Minister] Aroop Biswas did not let me work; they brought me into politics to use me,” Mr. Tiwary said in a video message.

He also alleged that he was coerced into joining the party and fighting the 2021 election as a Trinamool candidate.

Famous Bengali singer Kabir Suman, also a former Trinamool MP, told the local media that he was not a fan of the party and that he was coerced into contesting on their ticket in the past.

Cong. steps up attack on BJP over ‘vote theft’, ‘electoral engineering’

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Wednesday alleged that a significant number of BJP MPs in the Lok Sabha had won their seats through vote *chori* (theft). The ruling party would struggle to cross even 140 seats if the elections were held fairly today, he said.

In a post on X in Hindi, he said that “every sixth” BJP MP among its 240 Lok Sabha members had secured victory through electoral manipulation.



Rahul Gandhi

“They are not hard to identify – should we, in the BJP’s own parlance, label them ‘*ghuspathiya*’ [infiltrator]? And what of Haryana? There, the entire

government itself is ‘*ghuspathiya*’. The very institutions they keep in their pockets – the ones they manipulate to distort voter lists and the electoral process – are themselves ‘remote-controlled’,” Mr. Gandhi said. “Their real fear is the truth. For, if fair elections were held, they would not be able to win even 140 seats today,” he added.

Congress spokesperson Pawan Khera sharpened the attack, accusing the BJP of “systematic electoral engineering”. He said electoral rolls were being “de-

liberately manipulated” and democratic institutions “compromised” to produce favourable outcomes, particularly in West Bengal and Assam, which he termed “manufactured verdicts”.

“*Abki baar loktantra ka antim sanskar* [This time, final rites of the democracy],” Mr. Khera said, alleging that democratic processes had been hollowed out. Citing seats where deletions under the special intensive revision (SIR) were higher than the margin of victories, he called for judicial intervention.

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma on Wednesday submitted his resignation to Governor Lakshman Prasad Acharya, paving the way for the formation of a new government.

The Governor accepted Mr. Sarma’s request to dissolve the 15th Assam Legislative Assembly. He asked him to continue as the caretaker Chief Minister till the oath-taking ceremony.

Mr. Sarma told presspersons that the new Ministry



Formal process: Assam Governor Lakshman Prasad Acharya with outgoing Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma on Wednesday. PTI

would be sworn-in after May 11, by when the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) Legislature Party leader would be elected.

On Tuesday, the BJP Parliamentary Board appointed Union Minister J.P. Nadda the central observer and Haryana Chief Minis-

ter Nayab Singh Saini the co-observer for the election of the Assam BJP Legislature Party leader.

“Following the election of the leader, we will hold an NDA (National Democratic Alliance) meeting for a proposal to support the BJPLP leader,” Mr. Sarma said. He said the meeting would be held on or before May 11. “We will get to know the date from Nadda ji’s office by tomorrow,” he added.

A BJP spokesperson said Prime Minister Narendra Modi was likely to attend the oath-taking ceremony.

No word on Nishant’s inclusion ahead of Cabinet expansion

Amarnath Tewary
PATNA

Ahead of the Cabinet expansion of the Samrat Choudhary-led National Democratic Alliance government in Bihar on Thursday, Patna witnessed intense political activities. There was speculation that Nishant Kumar, son of former Chief Minister and JD(U) president Nitish Kumar, could be inducted into the new Cabinet.

Senior JD(U) leaders held several meetings in Patna on Wednesday, including at the residence of the party’s national working president, Sanjay Jha, leading to speculation over the possible political debut of Mr. Nishant. Later, the leaders also met Mr. Nitish.

The Cabinet expansion event scheduled to be held on Thursday at Gandhi Maidan here is expected to be attended by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Union Home Minister Amit Shah, BJP president Nitin Nabin and other senior

JD(U) leaders hold series of meetings in Patna; many call for induction of Nitish Kumar’s son

NDA leaders. However, no official confirmation has come out yet on Mr. Nishant’s inclusion.

Second leg of yatra

Mr. Nishant is currently on the *Sadbhav Yatra* across the State. He started the campaign from Champaran district on May 3 and will begin the second leg of his yatra from Vaishali on Thursday.

He had earlier indicated that he wanted to strengthen the party organisation and showed reluctance to join the Cabinet. However, speculation remains strong. “If Nishant joins the Cabinet, it will be like wish fulfilment for all party leaders and workers. We want him to lead us,” said State JD (U) president Umesh Kushwaha.

Opposition Benches in Rajya Sabha to see many changes after poll results

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

The sweeping changes in the Tamil Nadu, Kerala and West Bengal State Assemblies as a result of the recent elections are also set to alter the composition of the Opposition benches in the Rajya Sabha, with the Tamilaga Vetttri Kazhagam likely to debut in the Upper House in the next round of polls expected in mid-June.

If AIADMK MP C. Ve. Shanmugam, who won from the Mailam Assembly constituency, resigns his Rajya Sabha seat, then TVK could enter Parliament earlier than anticipated.

He told *The Hindu* that he will take a decision on the matter in the next couple of days. If he chooses to resign from the House, then the election for his seat could be held along with 22 other seats from eight States that are due to go to the polls in June. Considering the TVK’s strength in Assembly, it should be able to win the seat.

The biggest setback will be for the Left parties. In



Poll impact: Between the two rounds of Rajya Sabha elections this year, the Congress will pick up three extra berths. ANI

April 2027, three Kerala MPs are retiring: the IUML’s Abdul Wahab, and the CPI(M)’s John Brittas and V. Sivadasan. The Left Democratic Front’s collective strength of 35 seats in the Kerala Assembly is one short of the required number to elect a Rajya Sabha MP. In April 2028, their strength in the Upper House is set to dip further when another three Kerala seats go to the polls. Again, the Left is unlikely to have the numbers to get any of its candidates elected. CPI MP P.P. Suneer, who is scheduled to retire in

2030, will then be the last remaining Left MP in the Upper House.

Impact on DMK

The DMK benches will feel the impact in June 2028 when six MPs from Tamil Nadu are set to retire. Of these, three are from the DMK, two from the AIADMK, and one from the Congress. Considering the Assembly elected on May 4, and the subsequent Congress pledge to support the TVK, the DMK is likely to return only one MP to the Rajya Sabha.

For the Trinamool Con-

gress, the first hit will be slightly delayed, coming in August 2029, when the next round of Rajya Sabha elections is held for West Bengal. Six members from the State, five from the Trinamool and one from the BJP, are set to retire, including the Trinamool’s Rajya Sabha leader Derek O’Brien. Based on its present strength in the State Assembly, the Trinamool will only be able to get one member elected to the Upper House.

The next round of attrition from the Trinamool’s benches is expected in April 2030, when four of its MPs will retire, reducing its strength to six until the next round of Assembly polls in the State.

Between the two rounds of Rajya Sabha elections this year, the Congress will pick up three extra berths.

By the November, the Congress’s tally will go up from 30 to 33. The Congress will also increase its strength at the cost of the Left members in the Rajya Sabha in April 2027 and 2028.



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VACANCY NOTIFICATION NO. 1/2026
Online Applications are invited for the following Posts for **NIA, Panchkula**: Professor (14 Posts), Associate Professor (14 Posts), Assistant Professor (6 Posts), all in different Subjects, Medical Officer (1 Post), Deputy Director (Admn. & Fin.) (1 Post), Accountant (1 Post), Nursing Officer (1 Post) & Librarian (1 Post); And for the following Posts for **NIA, Jaipur**: Assistant Professor (5 Posts), Panchakarma Vaidya (1 Post), Radiologist (1 Post), Junior Translation Officer (1 Post), Accountant (1 Post) and Pharmacist (1 Post). All Details like Subjects, Reservations etc. are available in the Website of the Institute: www.nia.nic.in. Applications are to be filled Online only in the Website of the Institute. The Date of Starting of Online Filling of Applications is 11-5-2026. The Closing Date for Online Filling of Application is 20-6-2026. The Institute reserves the right to increase or decrease the number of vacancies, to withdraw the vacancy of any or all Posts and to reject any or all applications without assigning any reason, whatsoever.
JP SHARMA
Date: 5-5-2026
JOINT DIRECTOR (ADMN.)



M CH-CHE

Business

INBRIEF



‘HDFC Bank review finds no major governance concerns’

Law firms reviewing governance at HDFC Bank are set to report this month that they have not found any major lapses, two people with direct knowledge of the findings said, clearing the way for the reappointment of its CEO. India's largest private lender by assets called in Mumbai-based Trilegal and Wadia Ghandy & Co after Atanu Chakraborty resigned as CMD in March citing “incongruence” between his personal values and bank practices. He did not elaborate. The resignation was followed by a 13.81% drop in the bank's share price, or \$16 billion in the stock's value and prompted a rare statement from the central bank seeking to allay investor and depositor concern about a lender deemed too big to fail. It also threw into doubt the lender's application at the central bank due May-end to reappoint CEO Sashidhar Jagdishan. REUTERS

SP Group \$3 bn refinance: unit suffers debt downgrade

An Indian rating agency has downgraded a bond issued by Goswami Infratech, a Shapoorji Pallonji (SP) Group unit, citing delays in group-level fundraising versus earlier timelines and highlighting mounting refinancing risks. The real estate and civil engineering firm's non-convertible debentures were downgraded to B+, from BB-, CareEdge said on Wednesday. Shapoorji Pallonji Group did not immediately respond to a Reuters request for comment. Goswami Infratech's plan to raise between \$2.8 billion and \$3.1 billion over the past few months has been delayed, with the surge in rupee hedging costs playing a major role. The company has now planned to split its fresh fundraising between dollar and rupee bond issues, and would target the issues before the end of June, merchant bankers said. The firm raised \$1.51 billion in June 2023 via this bond issue. REUTERS

L&T bags up to 15,000-cr. order from JSW Steel

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Infrastructure major Larsen & Toubro (L&T) said it has received a ‘mega’ order worth ₹10,000-₹15,000 crore from JSW Steel.

As part of its strategic growth roadmap, JSW Steel is progressing towards expanding its crude steel processing capacity from 35 million tonne per annum (MTPA) to over 50 MTPA by 2031.

In line with this vision, L&T has been entrusted with the engineering, procurement and installation of critical process facilities, including blast furnaces and steel melt shops, mainly at JSW sites in Ballari, Karnataka and Paradip, Odisha, L&T said in a filing with the BSE.

‘April E-PV sales rose 75% to 23,506 units’

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Electric passenger vehicle (E-PV) sales in India grew by 75.1% year-on-year to 23,506 units in April, Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations (FADA) said on Wednesday.

Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles Ltd. led the market with 8,543 units compared with 4,822 units in the same month last year, at a growth of 77.2%, as per FADA data. Homegrown rival Mahindra & Mahindra Ltd. came second with 5,413 units, up almost 64% followed by JSW MG Motor India with 5,006 units, a growth of 32.5%.

In the electric two-wheeler segment, FADA said total sales were at 1,48,740 units last month compared with 92,538 un-



Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles led the market with 8,543 units.

its in April last year, up 60.7%.

TVS Motor Company was the segment leader with 37,683 units last month compared with 19,976 units in April 2025, up 88.6%.

Bajaj Auto Ltd. came second with 32,898 units against 19,162 units in April last year, a growth of 71.7%. Ather Energy came third with 27,034 units more than double last year.

NMDC raises iron ore prices by ₹200 per tonne

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

State-owned NMDC has increased iron ore prices by ₹200 a tonne in the latest revision effective May 6.

The new prices have been fixed at ₹5,500 per tonne for Baila Lump and ₹4,700 for the same quantity of Baila Fines, NMDC said in the revision, the second such this fiscal.

On April 5, NMDC, India's largest iron ore producer, had increased the price of Baila Lump by ₹500 per tonne to ₹5,300 and Baila Fines to ₹4,500 from ₹4,050 earlier. These are (FoR) freight on road/ rail prices exclusive of royalty, DMF, NMEDT, cess, Forest Permit Fee, transit fee, GST, environmental cess and taxes.

To minimise AI’s impact on jobs, ILO bats for lifelong learning

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Given the tumultuous trends reshaping labour markets across the world, lifelong learning needs to be a central pillar of governments’ economic and social policies, the International Labour Organization said. Growing digitalisation, artificial intelligence (AI), green transition and demographic shifts were identified as some of the factors driving this shift.

In a report released in Geneva on Tuesday, the ILO emphasised that lifelong learning was about



Key to success: Lifelong learning is the bridge between today's jobs and tomorrow's opportunities, says Hounghbo. GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCK

more than employability and productivity. “It underpins decent work, genuine innovation, active citizenship, and social inclusion, making it a cornerstone of any effective strategy for sustainable growth and development,” the report noted.

Lifelong learning is the bridge between today's

jobs and tomorrow's opportunities, added ILO Director-General Gilbert F. Hounghbo.

Strategic policy priority ILO argues lifelong learning should be elevated as a strategic policy priority, not just as a tool to raise productivity and facilitate sustainable growth but also as a systemic enabler of personal and societal advancement, equity, and decent work in 21st century.

It flags a ‘striking gap’ in comprehensive, authoritative, up-to-date research that captures the full scope of lifelong learning.

Russia’s share in Indian oil imports jumped in March

Outbreak of West Asian crisis hit India's Gulf oil supplies, making it turn to Russia; however, India is now getting Russian oil at a premium of 2.5% compared with a discount of 3.9% in 2025-26

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

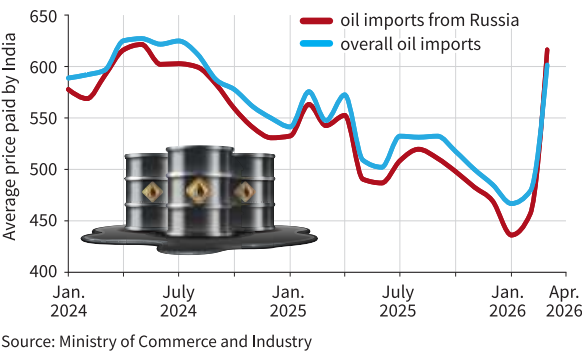
The West Asia crisis and the resultant supply constraints have meant that not only has Russia's share in India's oil imports jumped once again, but this time India is paying a substantial premium for Russian oil rather than the discount it was enjoying earlier.

An analysis by The Hindu of the latest data from the Ministry of Commerce and Industry shows that Russia's share in India's oil imports stood at 33.3% or one-third in March 2026, the first months after the West Asia crisis began. Simultaneously, the shares of the Gulf countries as well as the U.S. have fallen.

However, India is now getting Russian oil at a premium of 2.5% as compared with an average discount of

Pricey purchases

The West Asia crisis has resulted in the discount India enjoyed on Russian oil turning into a premium. (In \$ per tonne)



3.9% it had received earlier in 2025-26.

Dynamic strategies

In the run-up to the West Asia crisis, India was in the process of cutting back on Russian oil in an effort to align with U.S. interests and push forward a trade deal with that country. In

February, Russia's share had been 25% and in January, it had fallen to a 41-month low of 19%.

However, once the U.S. and Israel attacked Iran on February 28 and Iran retaliated by closing the crucial Strait of Hormuz, India had little choice but to look back to Russia as a major

oil supplier. In fact, in early March, the U.S. Treasury Department, too, issued an order to “allow” India to buy Russian oil for a period of 30 days. While India has maintained throughout that it retains the autonomy to decide where it imports oil from and how much.

Russia dependence

The data shows India substantially cut back on the volume of its overall oil imports in March 2026, likely because about a third of India's crude oil supplies depended on the Strait of Hormuz.

Total oil imports came in at 15.8 million metric tonne (MMT), down nearly 23% over February, and 41% lower than in March last year. However, out of this, Russia's share jumped to 33.3% even as India's Gulf supplies fell sharply.

RIL refinery to shut for maintenance after Nayara restarts

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A part of Reliance Industries' 33 million tonne per annum refinery would be heading for planned maintenance shutdown after Nayara Energy's Vadinar refinery returns to operations, Sujata Sharma, Joint Secretary at the Ministry of Petroleum Ministry told reporters on Wednesday.

“Right now, Nayara [Energy's] refinery is under shutdown which will come back mid of this month or before that, after that Reliance [refinery's planned maintenance] shutdown will start,” the bureaucrat said.

Planned maintenance shutdowns are routine at refineries. They are undertaken to sort repair work, preserve life cycle of equipment and ensure safety during operations. It takes about four weeks for refineries to complete planned maintenance and



A general view of Reliance refinery at Jamnagar.

return to operations.

Ms. Sharma elaborated that the government was seeking to ensure shutdown of refineries was regulated such that all of them do not shut down together.

“We in the Ministry try to ensure all the shutdowns do not happen at one time, and it is scattered so that the supply for domestic market is not affected,” she stated while elaborating on maintenance shutdowns.

SEBI terms indices with over ₹20,000-cr. AUM as ‘significant’

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) specified that a Benchmark or Index (including index of indices) based on listed securities shall be considered as ‘Significant Indices’, if the daily aver-

beyond ₹20,000 crore.

In a circular, SEBI said the threshold would be tested every six months.

“It is specified a Benchmark or Index (including index of indices) based on listed securities shall be considered as ‘Significant Indices’, if the daily aver-

age cumulative AUM tracking the Benchmark or Index across schemes of Mutual Fund(s) exceeds ₹20,000 crore for each of past six months, ending on 30th June and 31st December each year”. SEBI mentioned 48 indices including BSE 100 and BSE 500.

Reuters
NEW DELHI

India's Zee Entertainment has sued the Reliance-Disney joint venture, the country's biggest entertainment company, alleging it used Zee's copyrighted music after licence

agreements expired, court documents show.

Zee is seeking \$3 million in damages, alleging unauthorised use and exploitation of works from its music division on the Reliance-Disney streaming platform and some of its TV channels, according to

previously unreported court papers seen by Reuters. The lawsuit, filed in New Delhi and reported by Reuters for the first time, marks the latest legal clash between Zee and the group formed from Reliance and Disney's \$8.5 billion merger in 2024.

TENDER NOTICE
GST & C.Ex Commissionerate
No.1, Goubert Avenue, Beach Road, Puducherry
Security Services
Tenders are invited through GeM portal for Hiring of security services for the period from 01.07.2026 to 30.06.2028 by GST & C.Ex Commissionerate No.1 Goubert Avenue Beach Road, Puducherry.
Interested Bidders may visit <https://gem.gov.in> and participate in the bidding process. GeM bid document No.
GEM/2026/B/7470754 dated 24.04.2026.
Bid end Date : 15.05.2026 (17:00 hrs)
Contact No. 0413-2330368
Applicants should have business / registered office in Puducherry.

SOUTHERN RAILWAY
Salem Division
Office of the Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer
Electric Loco Shed, Erode
E-Tender Notice No. SA_A_RS_ED_OT_26_27_6,
Dated: 05.05.2026
Online tender is invited for the following work:
Tender No SA_A_RS_ED_OT_26_27_6, Dated: 05.05.2026
Description of Work Works contract for Reconditioning of Smoothing Shed (SL-30) of electric locomotives available at Electric Loco Shed, Southern Railway, Salem Division, Erode.
All details regarding the tender are available at <https://www.ireps.gov.in>
Senior Divisional Electrical Engineer / Rolling Stock / Erode
For and on behalf of the President of India

CHITTARANJAN LOCOMOTIVE WORKS
NOTICE FOR INVITING EOI
No. Med/G/Dialysis/CLW/2026-2028, Dated - 27.04.2026. The undersigned invites applications from willing HCO's for Establishment and Management Haemodialysis unit at Kasturba Gandhi Hospital, CLW/Chittaranjan for the period of Two Years. The details are uploaded in website www.clw.indianrailways.gov.in. Interested applicants/bidders are requested to submit their application in the format attached in (page-5) and submit in a sealed cover with superscription sealed envelope superscribed in bold letter "EOI For Establishment And Management Of Haemodialysis Unit At Kasturba Gandhi Hospital, CLW/Chittaranjan" and to be submitted to PCMO/G office on or before 13.00 hours on 01/06/2026.
[PR4/340] ACMS/A/CLW/Chittaranjan
Like us on: www.facebook.com/clwrailways

MAHATRANSCO
INVITATION FOR BID (IFB) (LOCAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING)
SRM e-Tender No. T-2628 /MSETCL/CO/Projects/Pre Tender (RFx No. 6000001508)
MSETCL invites offers by SRM e-tendering in TWO bid system (Techno-Commercial Bid and Price Bid) from the eligible registered bidders for the following work as detailed below.
"Construction of LILO on 132kV Dahanu-Ambesari line at 132kV Dapcheri Substation (Route Length- 12.536km) alongwith 2x132kV Line bays at 132kV Dapcheri Substation on turnkey basis, Dist, Palghar under Vashi Zone, MSETCL."
Interested bidders may obtain further information available on the website <https://srmetender.mahatransco.in>
The date of downloading of Bid documents available on the website is from 05.05.2026.
Sd/-
Chief Engineer (Projects), MSETCL

PROCLAMATION
REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
(Section 82, Code of Criminal Procedure)
In the Court of the XI Additional City Civil & Sessions Judge for CBI Cases, Singaravelar Maaligai (Collectorate Building), Chennai – 1.
Calender Case No.07/2018
Split up from C.C.No.06/2006
in R.C.No.3/A/2004
SPE/CBI/ACB/Chennai
Whereas complaint has been made before me that Mr.P.Balan (A7 in Main case), S/o. Paramasivam, No.7/8, Parvathi Amman Street, State Bank Colony 2nd Street, Ezhil Nagar, Madhavaram Milk Colony, Madhavaram, Chennai - 600 051 aged about 65 years has committed the offence of Cheating the Bank in the matter of sanction of loan punishable under section 120-B r/w 420, 468 and 471 IPC and Sec.13(2) r/w 13(1) (d) of PC Act, 1988, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said P.Balan cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said P.Balan has absconded.
Proclamation is hereby made that the said P.Balan is required to appear in person before the XI Additional City Civil & Sessions Court for CBI Cases, Singaravelar Maaligai, Chennai-1 to answer the said complaint on the 15th day of June, 2026 without fail.
Dated this the 13th day of March, 2026.
Sd./-
XI Addl. Spl. Judge for CBI Cases, Chennai.

SOUTHERN RAILWAY
Chennai Division
Applications are invited by The Sr.Divisional Commercial Manager, Southern Railway, Chennai Division, Chennai-600 003 for and on behalf of The President of India for engagement of facilitators for issue of Unreserved Tickets through Automatic Ticket Vending Machine (ATVM) Installed in Stations over MAS Division (Locations) from Retired Railway Employees & General Public
Application Ref No Name of Work Location
M/C. 378/ATVM/2025 Application for appointment of ATVM facilitators over MAS Division 53 Locations over Chennai Division (List of locations are available in website)
Date and Time for Submission of application On 26.05.2026 (Tuesday) between 10.00 hrs to 15.00 hrs
Opening of application form 15:30 hrs on 26.05.2026 (Tuesday)
Website address (for detailed information) [https://sr.indianrailways.gov.in/sr/notice/1777970095918_Notification for ATVM facilitator-050526.pdf](https://sr.indianrailways.gov.in/sr/notice/1777970095918_Notification%20for%20ATVM%20facilitator-050526.pdf)
If the date of receipt of applications and opening of Application happens to be declared as Holiday, the same will be on the next working day.
Divisional Railway Manager / Commercial / Chennai - 600 003

SOUTHERN RAILWAY
CHENNAI DIVISION (WORKS BRANCH)
E-TENDER NOTICE No. 14 / 2026, Dated: 05.05.2026
S. No Item No Description
1 MAS140F26059E Essential urgent works to eliminate deficiencies on Main line track including removal of Garbage, Rag Picking and Clearing of track between BBO-ENR, KOK-WST, KOK-VPY in for a period of one year.
2 MAS140F26060C Essential urgent P.Way repair works to eliminate deficiencies on track between MSB-VPY section.
3 MAS140F26061C Removal of vegetation, jungle & bushes and weed control at VLK - AJJ in SSE/P.Way/AVD, TRL & KBT for the period of Two years
4 MAS140F26062W Reconditioning of CMS Crossings IN SITU by using RW-20 Translamic Robotic Welding technology in ADEN/AJJ, KPD & JTY sub divisions.
5 MAS140F26063E Providing service for Daily monitoring of Oscillations at floor level of the Cabs of nominated pair of trains running over SR.
Date and Time of Tender Opening - 28.05.2026 @ 11.30 Hrs.
Complete details & Tender Document will be available at <https://www.ireps.gov.in>
Divisional Railway Manager / Works / Chennai - 03

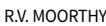
Can't be distracted by how other teams are playing, says Malolan



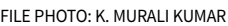
'We have looked long and hard
at how to play at Ekana Stadium'



He's batting at a different level: Finch heaps praise on Samson



We would ideally want Kuldeep
to be better than this: Badani



Kishan and Klaasen shine as Sunrisers sink Kings, go top

IPL-19

Rampant RCB faces a tricky LSG challenge



DC grapples with wide variance in home pitches

10

INBRIEF



Fans ‘set the standards’ at rocking Emirates: Arteta

Mikel Arteta said that Arsenal fans “set the standards” after the Gunners reached the Champions League final on Tuesday. Arteta said that his players fed off the fizzing atmosphere at the Emirates. “I think they set the standards and we tried to catch up with them immediately. It’s so good after so many years to give that joy back to them and see that pride in their eyes.”



Atletico boss Simeone feeling calm and peaceful

Atletico Madrid coach Diego Simeone said he was at peace and proud of how far his team had made it. “If we got knocked out, it’s because our opponents deserved to get through,” he said. “If you ask me how I feel, I feel calm and peaceful.”

FIFA confirms ban for Argentina’s Prestianni

FIFA, on Wednesday, confirmed a global ban for Gianluca Prestianni that will rule the Benfica winger out of two World Cup games in the USA if he is selected in Argentina’s squad.

India’s disappointing campaign at World TT ends

India’s campaign at the World table tennis team championships ended with women’s 3-1 loss to USA in round of 32 in London. The men too lost in a round of 32 clash against Austria on Tuesday.

The result: USA 3 bt India 1 (Sally Moyland bt Yashaswini Ghorpade 11-8, 11-8, 11-7; Jessica Reyes lost to Manika Batra 2-11, 8-11, 11-8, 4-11; Lily Zhang bt Diya Chitale 11-8, 11-7, 13-11; Sally bt Manika 10-12, 11-9, 11-3, 13-11).

New Delhi to host C’wealth TT in July-August

New Delhi will host 22nd Commonwealth table tennis championship between July 27 and August 2 which will see participation from 35 nations.

ENGAGEMENTS

Cricket: TNCA II div., multi-day semifinals, Egmore RC vs Bunts (Wahe Guru ‘A’), UFCC (T. Nagar) vs Pristine (Jones Krish, turf), first day, 9 a.m.

Gukesh sends out a massive message by beating Sindarov

CHESS

Press Trust of India
WARSAW

Reigning world champion D. Gukesh on Wednesday sent out a massive message to chess buffs across the globe by beating his challenger for the world crown, Javokhir Sindarov of Uzbekistan in the fifth round of the Super Rapid and Blitz, a part of the Grand Chess Tour, here.

Gukesh had earlier walked out of the main competition of the Grand Chess Tour, citing his form and to focus more on training ahead of his World Championship title defence.

In full swing

He was, however, in full swing as he matched Sindarov move for move in a rapid encounter. The Uz-



Statement win: Gukesh wrapped up the win against Sindarov in 52 moves. FLICKR/GRANDCHESSTOUR

bek Grandmaster had earlier dismissed claims that this was an important clash ahead of the World Championship match but his play clearly showed he was under some pressure.

Interestingly enough, Gukesh and Sindarov both lost their previous games coming into this round. Gukesh was outdone by Radoslaw Wojtashek of Poland while Sindarov lost to tournament leader Wesley So of the United States.

Saka ends Arsenal’s 20-year wait to reach Champions League final

The winger’s strike late in the first half seals a narrow 1-0 second-leg win over Atletico Madrid for an aggregate 2-1 result in the semifinal



Clinical: Saka fires in from close range for Arsenal’s winner. REUTERS

Agence France-Presse
LONDON

Arsenal reached the Champions League final for the first time in 20 years as Bukayo Saka sealed a 1-0 win against Atletico Madrid on Tuesday.

Mikel Arteta’s side settled the semifinal second leg with Saka’s strike late in the first half at an ecstatic

Emirates Stadium.

The Gunners, who drew 1-1 in the first leg in Madrid last week, held firm after Saka’s goal to go through 2-1 on aggregate.

Arsenal will face Paris Saint-Germain or Bayern Munich in the final in Budapest on May 30.

It was a cathartic night for Arsenal, which is back in the Champions League final for the first time since

losing 2-1 to Barcelona in its only previous appearance in the showpiece in 2006.

Even Arsene Wenger’s ‘Invincibles’ – who won the club’s last English title in an unbeaten top-flight campaign in 2004 – might have to bow to the current generation if they finish the job. Fittingly, it was Saka – the homegrown symbol of the Arteta era – who proved Arsenal’s

match-winner.

This was a more prosaic display but no-one with an affinity to Arsenal was bothered in the slightest.

Arsenal was nearly caught on the counter in a frenetic start when Julian Alvarez shot just wide before Giuliano Simeone’s close-range effort deflected past the post.

But Arsenal recovered from those anxious mo-



Gunners fire on all cylinders

Arsenal scales new heights during its semifinal win over Atletico

14 Arsenal set a new club record when it extended its unbeaten streak in the ongoing Champions League (CL) season to 14 matches

14 Saka has been directly involved in 14 goals in as many CL appearances at home

30 Having shut out Atletico at the Emirates Stadium, Gunners recorded their 30th clean sheet across competitions this season

41 By registering its 41st victory of the 2025-26 campaign, the current Arsenal squad equalled the club record for most wins in a season (previous: in 1970-71)

44 When the final kicks off on May 30, Arteta, at 44y 65d, will become the second youngest manager to lead Arsenal in a major European title decider. Terry Neill (38y 6d) is the youngest

ments to deliver a dominant spell that brought its 44th minute goal.

Viktor Gyokeres’ clever run unhinged the Atletico defence and his cross reached Leandro Trossard inside the area.

Trossard wriggled into just enough space for a low drive that Jan Oblak weakly pushed out to Saka, who reacted quicker than his flat-footed markers to slot

home from four yards.

Atletico tried to ruin the party in the second half, but Gabriel Magalhaes made a last-ditch tackle on Simeone to avert a certain goal before David Raya repelled Antoine Griezmann’s blast.

The result (semifinal, second leg):

Arsenal 1 (Saka 44) bt Atletico 0 (Arsenal wins 2-1 on aggregate).

Hnamte own goal helps Punjab edge past Chennaiyin FC

ISL

Vivek Krishnan
NEW DELHI

In a game of few clear-cut chances, it seemed rather apt that Punjab FC’s 1-0 win against Chennaiyin FC in the Indian Super League fixture on Wednesday was courtesy an own goal in the 84th minute.

In the endeavour to mark Suresh Meitei during a Punjab corner, Chennaiyin’s Lahrinliana Hnamte had his back on goal, and was totally oblivious to Daniel Ramirez’s cross hitting his body before going into the net.

Crucial result

The result takes Punjab, which has 18 points after 10 matches, to sixth spot in the standings. Chennaiyin continues to



On the rise: Punjab FC moved up to sixth in the standings with a victory at home. INSTAGRAM/INDIANSUPERLEAGUE

languish at 12th with nine points.

The host, which enjoyed 60% of the possession, was deserving of the

victory after looking the more threatening of the two teams.

Ramirez, the attacking midfielder from Spain with

a creative spark, orchestrated most of the attacks.

The first genuine opportunity came in the 11th minute when Ramirez teed up Bede Osuji on a platter, but the latter’s shot was cleared off the goal-line by defender Pritam Kotal.

In the 25th minute, Ramirez again turned provider as he found Nsungusi Effiong on the left with a perfectly-weighted pass.

But Effiong didn’t get a clear sight at goal much to the credit of Chennaiyin goalkeeper Mohammad Nawaz, who charged forward and narrowed the angle for the Punjab striker.

Just a minute later, Chennaiyin had one of its rare openings when Irfan Yadwad’s pass found Hnamte in a superb position inside the box.

He squandered the initiative, however, with a heavy first touch.

Indian compound men’s team narrowly misses bronze

ARCHERY

Sports Bureau

The Indian compound men’s team, comprising Ojas Deotale, Sahil Jadhav and Kushal Dalal, narrowly missed a bronze medal after losing to China at the Archery World Cup Stage-2 in Shanghai on Wednesday.

The teams were tied 234-234, forcing a shoot-off. As the tie-breaker ended 30-30, China, which shot two Xs against India’s one, was declared the winner in a battle for the bronze.

The results:
Recurve: Qualification:
Individual: Men: B. Dhiraj (seventh, 679), Tarundeep Rai (29th, 661), Yashdeep Bhoge (54th, 653), Atanu Das (67th, 643);

Women: Ankita Bhakat (10th, 652), Kumkum Mohod (11th, 651), Deepika Kumari (14th, 651), Simranjeet Kaur (15th, 648).

Team: India: Men (eighth, 1993), Women (fourth, 1954), Mixed (sixth, 1331).

Elimination: Men: First round: Tarundeep Rai bt Mukhammadkodir Ergashev (Uzb) 6-2, Atanu Das lost to Mohd. Mishad Prodhan (Ban) 3-7, Yashdeep Bhoge bt Diego Conde Collar (Spn) 7-1, B. Dhiraj got byes (in first two rounds).
Compound: Elimination: Team: Men: India (Ojas Deotale, Sahil Jadhav, Kushal Dalal) got a bye (first round), bt Germany 238-230 (second round), bt Chinese Taipei 233-231 (quarterfinal), lost to USA 234-235 (semifinal), lost to China 234-234 (30-30*, Chinese archers shot closer to the centre).

Women: India (Aditi Swami, Pragati, V. Jyothi Surekha) bt Slovenia 228-227 (first round), lost to Türkiye 227-223 (quarterfinal).

Guntas to lead at Queen Sirikit Cup

Sports Bureau
NEW DELHI

A three-member Indian team led by 2025 Ladies Order of Merit winner Guntas Kaur Sandhu will participate in the prestigious Queen Sirikit Cup golf later this month.

The event from May 12-15, officially the Asia-Pacific Amateur Ladies Golf Team Championship, will be held at Bogor, Indonesia with 15 countries participating including Australia, China, Japan, New Zealand and defending champion Korea.

Besides the 15-year-old Chandigarh-based Guntas, Haryana’s Ceerat Kang and Delhi’s Keya Badugu are the others in the team named by the Indian Golf Union on Wednesday.

The Queen Sirikit Cup is considered one of the top amateur competitions in golf.

TNCA LEAGUE

Kovai Knights wins fifth division league title

CHENNAI: A. Vishvajith’s 106 (123b, 12x4) and left-arm spinner R. Rohith Ram’s six for 31 helped Kovai Knights defeat Prasad CC by 185 runs in the TNCA fifth division league championship final.

In the fourth division championship match, Chatnath RC defeated TSR MSC by eight wickets.

The scores:
IV: Championship: TSR MSC 109 in 36.1 overs (Shanmugasundararaja 32, D. Govindaraj 43, S. Vasanth Saravanan 5/33, S. Harish 3/22) lost to Chatnath 113/2 in 22.3 overs (B. Rahul 42 n.o., M. Sivanesh 30).
Championship play-offs: Royapettah 175 in 48.3 overs (L.B. Naveen Balaji 64, G. Selvakumar 3/39, S. Harish 3/51, Kanishka C. Arvind 3/42) lost to Chatnath 176/3 in 40 overs (M. Thiagarajar 83 n.o., A. Aarif 43 n.o., M. Sivanesh 32).
Relegation: Unicorn 117 in 38.5 overs (C.S. Mithun 31, A. Tharun 32, S.P. Sundara Raghu Raman



Vishvajith (Kovai Knights, 106); Rohith (Kovai Knights, 6/31); Kowsigan (Kovai Knights, 126 n.o.); Raghu Raman (Vijay’s RC, 3/11 including hat-trick); Prahaladh (Minerva, 7/45); Naveen (Sumangali Homes, 5/31).

3/11 including a hat-trick, V.G. Deenadayalan 3/27) lost to Vijay’s RC 118/9 in 39.1 overs (K.S. Navaneeth 44).
Relegation play-off: Sumangali Homes 218/9 in 50 overs (Mayank Das 45, S. Harish Kumar 46, K. Karthikeyan 36, P. Naveen Kumar 31 n.o., M. Raja 4/46) bt Vijay’s RC 181 in 44.1 overs (Sakthivel 47, M. Balamurugan 35, P. Naveen Kumar 5/31, G. Babu 3/49).

V: Championship: Kovai Knights 286/7 in 50 overs (A. Vishvajith 106, G.S. Kowsigan 33, Nitish Venugopal 43, I. Ananth 47 n.o., A. Prabhakaran 4/95) bt Prasad 101 in 20.5 overs (J. Jenish 32, Vansh N. Mehta 34, R. Venkatesh 4/23, R. Rohith Ram 6/31).

Championship play-offs: Ethiraj 185 in 49.2 overs (S. Ashwanth Reddy 50, S. Karthik 52, R. Venkatesh 4/58, K. Narasimhan 4/32) lost to Kovai



Saravanan (Chatnath, 5/33); Sathish (Gandhi, 5/44).

Knights 191/2 in 21.1 overs (G.S. Kowsigan 126 n.o.).

Youth Centre 144 in 45.2 overs (S. Kaushik Babu 34, Ramesh Thangaraj 3/49) lost to Prasad 148/6 in 33.3 overs (K. Jenish 84 n.o.).

VI: Championship: Gandhi 237/8 in 30 overs (R. Sathish Kumar 89, G. Naveen Kumar 50, S. Krishna Kumar 3/73) bt Grand Prix 213/7 in 30 overs (R. Elango 65, Abdul Malik 63 n.o., R. Sathish Kumar 3/50).

Championship play-offs: Grand Prix 197 in 29.5 overs (M. Chandrabose 46, S. Padmanaban 48, M.R. Prahaladh 7/45) bt Minerva 126 in 26.3 (P. Naveen 32, K. Pradeepak Kumar 3/18, Arun Buvanesh 3/32, M. Maheshwaran 3/19).
Gandhi 218/7 in 30 overs (R. Sathish Kumar 39, A. Guru Prasad 55 n.o.) bt TFU 172 in 27.4 overs (H. Tholkappian 31, R. Sathish Kumar 5/44).

LIVE TELECAST

IPL: Star Sports 1 & JioHotstar, 7.30 p.m.

Europa League: Sony Sports Ten 1, 2 & LIV, 12.30 a.m. (Friday)

Conference League: Sony Sports Ten 3, 5 & LIV, 12.30 a.m. (Friday)



Can Wolvaardt 2.0 take the Proteas to the promised land?

For a batter who relies on old-school technique to amass runs, the recent series triumph against India showed her in a different avatar. It could augur well for South Africa in England

GETTY IMAGES

P.K. Ajith Kumar

Laura Wolvaardt 4, India 1. That could very well have been the scoreline in the recent five-match T20I series in South Africa. The only match India won was the one in which Wolvaardt failed to reach 20. That was in the fourth T20I at Johannesburg, in which she was out for 18. That was the game in which Deepti Sharma regained her touch as one of the premier all-rounders in the women's game, claiming five wickets after making an unbeaten 36 off 26 balls. The visitors won by 14 runs, but the South Africans had already clinched the series. The rubber had been decided in the previous match, which was also played at the Wanderers. And that game produced one of the best knocks in women's cricket of late. Wolvaardt's 115 off 53 balls was a masterclass in T20 batting. The 27-year-old's third hundred in the format helped her team get past the target set by India - 192 - with 3.3 overs remaining. It was the highest successful chase for South Africa. It was Wolvaardt's third T20I hundred, and it was her fastest - off 47 balls. All those records matter, yes. The way she lorded over the Indian attack, right from the start, mattered too. She, and her opening partner, Sune Luus gave Harmanpreet Kaur's women no chance despite putting on the board what was a challenging total. While the former played the supporting role admirably with a 42-ball 64 not out, the current one destroyed the Indian bowlers; she was generous enough to give a couple of chances, but this was, of course, a series that would not be exactly remembered for India's fielding; even some of its best fielders, like Jemimah Rodrigues, fumbled. Wolvaardt, of course, made India pay for those lapses. And she did it with some spectacular shots, like she did all through the series. She began by sending Renuka past the midwicket boundary off the first ball of the innings. The swing bowler was later swung for a couple of big sixes on the on-side. The innings, in particular, showcased how increasingly aggressive Wolvaardt is becoming as a top-order batter. She has always been admired for her elegant batting - her cover drive is pure art - and the way she could anchor her team's innings, or the way she could pace her knock. And talking of her cover drive, Australian great Meg Lanning had once famously replied to an ICC tweet asking fans who had the best cover drive of the generation.

Usual suspects
The international cricket body had put out pictures of some usual suspects: Virat Kohli, Kane Williamson, Joe Root and Babar Azam. Those were lovely pictures,

too, of all the men playing one of the most classical, aesthetically pleasing shots in the game. The images looked especially lovelier as the players were all in their whites. The picture Lanning posted of Wolvaardt had the South African in yellow and green - because she hadn't played a Test yet and there sadly are far too few games for women in the longest - and greatest - format. But, that image still brought out the beauty of the lady's cover drive. Come to think of it, there is no gender to the sheer art of batting. Just think of Smriti Mandhana; she is as stylish as a male left-hander. Women's cricket needs entertainers like Smriti and Wolvaardt. The game may have taken off in a big way in India - the ODI World Cup victory could not have been timed better - the WPL and The Hundred may be bringing in new fans, but it is still evolving. There is potential for the sport to grow further. And for that, superstars like Wolvaardt can be handy. She could inspire a lot more young girls in her country. Women's cricket had received a major boost when the team reached the final of the T20 World Cup in 2023 at home. South Africa went down to the invincible Australia in the final. All-rounder Marizanne Kapp had told this writer back then how much it meant to become the first senior South African team - male or female - to reach a World Cup final. "The support we received at the World Cup from the crowds was amazing," she said. "But, still you won't be remembered for playing the semifinals, you will be remembered for winning World Cups. We can't get stuck on us reaching the final." Well, three years later, South African women are still stuck there. They played the final of the 2024 T20 World Cup against New Zealand and then the 2025 ODI World Cup final against India. In last November's final at the DY Patil Stadium, the host had asked the South Africans to chase at nearly six an over. Not an easy task in a final in front of a full house, but as long as Wolvaardt was there, they had hope. She was dismissed for a 98-ball 101 in the 42nd over. Once the opener went, the remaining three wickets fell quickly. Former India captain Shubhangi Kulkarni rates that innings very highly. "I thought Wolvaardt played brilliantly in the final against India and South Africa was very much in the game when she was at the wicket," she tells *The Hindu*. "She showed great temperament, which I think is her best quality. Under pressure, in crucial roles, in major tournaments, she has been able to perform well."

She had performed alright in the semifinal against England at Guwahati. It was her 169 off 143 balls - she got out off the last ball of the 48th over - that helped South Africa set a far too big total that denied the Englishwomen a third straight final. Wolvaardt finished the World Cup as its leading scorer, with 571 runs, 137 more than the second-placed Smriti. Apart from two hundreds, she had also hit three fifties and had an average of 71.37. That World Cup had begun disastrously for Wolvaardt and South Africa though. At the Barsapara Cricket Stadium, the same venue as the semifinal, against the same team, England, she was out in the second over, her leading edge ending up as a return catch to left-arm spinner Linsey Smith. The South African innings lasted just four balls more than a T20I innings, and totalled 69. After England chased down that score in just 14.1 overs, Wolvaardt addressed the media. One recalls how calmly she took on the questions from the reporters on that October evening. "We are a much, much better side than 69 all out," she had said. "We spent a lot of time in these conditions in the last couple of months, so definitely wouldn't put it on the wicket." That was a captain talking. She sounded confident that her team could bounce back despite a poor start and it was such a long tournament, with every team getting

seven games in the league stage. South Africa indeed bounced back. And Wolvaardt led from the front. "She has been an excellent captain," says Shubhangi. "She is a leader, and has shown a lot of maturity." The Pune-based veteran rates Wolvaardt as one of the best batters of all time in women's cricket. "She is technically correct and is a classical batter, and I was really surprised she was not bought by any franchise at the inaugural WPL in 2023 (she came in as a replacement for Gujarat Giants' Beth Mooney, who was injured in the opening game of the tournament)," she says. "She plays proper cricketing shots and is good across formats." Wolvaardt has played just four Tests, though. She has a hundred and fifty from them. She averages a remarkable 51.30 in ODIs. No current player has a better number. She has 5695 runs in the format, with 13 hundreds and 40 fifties. In T20Is, apart from the three hundreds, she has 16 fifties. Yes, some of those came against India in the recent series, in which her scores read 51, 54, 115, 18, 92 not out. She could not have timed those innings better, either: the T20 World Cup in England is just five weeks away. Wolvaardt will be determined to make a statement in the group of death. She will do that with flair, you can bet.

THE GIST

Women's cricket needs entertainers like Smriti and Wolvaardt. The game may have taken off in a big way in India - the ODI World Cup victory could not have been timed better

There is potential for the sport to grow further. And for that, superstars like Wolvaardt can be handy. She could inspire a lot more young girls in her country

Her scores against India read 51, 54, 115, 18, 92 not out. She could not have timed those innings better, either: the T20 World Cup in England is just five weeks away.



Invasive species may be the wrong enemy in a changing subcontinent

India supports roughly 500 million cattle and other livestock, one of the largest such populations in the world, placing heavy grazing pressure on forests and the commons; in such conditions, ‘palatable’ species are suppressed while thorny, chemically defended, disturbance-tolerant plants persist

Suprabha Seshan

Across India, campaigns against invasive alien species (IAS) are gathering administrative and judicial force. Authorities now identify, map, classify, and remove species deemed ecological threats.

In the last year alone, India’s English-language press has carried sustained coverage of ecological-loss studies, State eradication drives, and human-wildlife conflicts linked to such species. What was once a niche scientific concern has become a visible public issue and priority.

A recent Tamil Nadu court order even portrayed *Prosopis juliflora* shrubs as a near-Statewide threat. Government submissions have reported its clearance from 517 villages across 32 districts while the academic literature has recorded the species across the State. The plants *Lantana camara* and *Senna spectabilis* face similar campaigns elsewhere in India.

The prevailing assumption is simple: remove the invasive species and ecological recovery will follow.

Before accepting that, however, one must first ask: what condition was the landscape in before these species spread, and what conditions now sustain them?

Three patterns emerge from the evidence.

Physical changes usually came first Throughout India, native ecological communities had already been transformed before invasive plants became dominant.

Colonial forestry, plantation expansion, and settlement removed vast tracts of forest cover. Millions of hectares were converted to tea, coffee, rubber, teak, and eucalyptus plantations. Diverse habitats gave way to simplified commercial landscapes, with lasting effects on soil biology, shade regimes, and water cycles. Logging, roads, mining, fire suppression, and chemical agriculture fragmented habitats further.

In places like Wayanad, forest edges had already degraded before species like *L. camara* spread into them. Biodiversity and its supporting conditions had already been decimated.

Removing a species alone can’t restore what came before. Without functioning ecological relationships, more clearing creates new vacancies, often the very conditions in which another invasive species, or the same one, can quickly return.

P. juliflora was introduced to India in 1877 as part of a misguided ecological experiment. At first seeded from the air, it spread through the guts of cattle that browsed its pods. Then came the ‘Green Revolution’ and the wider post-independent agricultural intensification. Canals expanded. Borewells multiplied. Fertilizer use surged.

As a result, waterlogging and seepage increased in some regions, depleted aquifers in others, and productivity began to decline on abandoned lands. *P. juliflora* is a deep-rooted phreatophyte that can exploit such altered water and soil regimes. In parts of Tamil Nadu, researchers have linked its surge to irrigation-related moisture conditions.

In other words, the plant was present for decades – what changed was the landscape around it.

Climate change, nutrient loading, land-use change, freshwater disruption,



India uses 35-40 million tonnes of urea per year and atmospheric nitrogen deposition now adds 10-30 kg per hectare annually across many regions. Woody nitrogen-fixing species such as *Senna spectabilis* (shown) benefit from such altered conditions. PHILIPP WEIGELL (CC BY)

biodiversity loss, and chemical pollution are reshaping ecosystems worldwide. These are largely the effects of a globalised industrial culture pushing rapid urbanisation and infrastructure expansion.

Over three decades, India’s urban governance footprint has roughly doubled, marking a systemic expansion of fragmented, high-disturbance landscapes that extend far beyond city boundaries into peri-urban and rural ecologies.

India also supports roughly 500 million cattle and other livestock – one of the largest such populations in the world – placing continuous and heavy grazing pressure on forests and the commons. In such conditions, ‘palatable’ species are repeatedly suppressed while thorny, chemically defended, disturbance-tolerant plants such as *L. camara* persist or even expand.

Studies have revealed increasing woody cover across many open landscapes worldwide, partly associated with rising atmospheric carbon and other interacting factors. Fertilizer inputs remain high – India alone uses 35-40 million tonnes of urea per year – and atmospheric nitrogen deposition now adds 10-30 kg per hectare annually across many regions. Woody nitrogen-fixing species such as *S. spectabilis* and *P. juliflora* benefit from such altered conditions.

A deeper invasion Chemical pesticides have further altered soils and microbial networks. Over time, they can disrupt genes, reduce resilience, intensify pest cycles, and weaken the ecological foundations on which productivity itself depends.

These changes were driven less by individual choice than by policies, infrastructure, and economic systems designed to maximise production at scale. The result: food production must continue yet the same hydrological, chemical, and atmospheric systems that

increase output are also exhausting the land and degrading ecosystems now slated for restoration.

When multiple factors shift together, plant communities reorganise. *P. juliflora* growth is part of wider hydrological and chemical change across the subcontinent. Similar dynamics may apply, in differing ways, to other IAS. These plants may function as ecological first responders – species whose physiology suits rapid changes in landscape conditions.

Given time, other species follow these pioneer species. In the early stages, many may be exotic and fast-moving. Eventually, native species may also re-establish themselves. However, such ecological succession does not guarantee a return to earlier ecological states. As the underlying conditions continue to shift, new ecological assemblages are likely to emerge among the species able to thrive within them.

Life is conditional Evolutionary and palaeoecological evidence suggests that the world’s native biomes developed under very different climatic and nutrient regimes. Grasslands expanded during drier phases of history while rainforests arose and diversified in warmer, wetter conditions. Many species can’t easily tolerate the nutrient-rich soils, altered climate or hydrologically changed landscapes of the present.

Some IAS species may also perform compensatory ecological roles. They can accumulate heavy metals, nitrogen, and carbon in biomass, provide cover for smaller wildlife in disturbed landscapes, create conditions into which other species later enter, provide windbreaks, and bind soil. There are, of course, real consequences. Dense thickets of invasive plants can reduce accessible forage for elephants and other herbivores in forests such as the Western Ghats. But these effects unfold in landscapes already altered by logging, plantations, and nutrient enrichment.

Conservation efforts that target only the visible plant thus risk misdiagnosing the problem. It is easier to count acres of IAS removed than to measure shifts in moisture regimes or soil chemistry. Removal alone does not address the underlying drivers. Restoration requires that we read the land comprehensively, understand its history and interacting processes, and work with the ecological and human communities that remain.

What it will take This does not mean certain species should never be removed but that restoration is difficult and requires attention to ecological processes and biodiversity. It is local, patient, and continuous. Large-scale mechanical removal brings complications of its own. While clearing vast acreages may serve a burgeoning biomass economy, there is little proof that it supports ecological recovery, which needs time.

Fears that invasive species will take over often accompany business opportunities for earthmovers and new employment schemes. A villain, it seems, can animate an economy faster than restoration can.

Communities and practitioners embedded in these habitats are often best placed to undertake careful removal where it makes ecological and cultural sense. Success, however, remains uncertain and can only be judged over years. Restoration should proceed with least harm, phased planting, intergenerational care, and meaningful human livelihoods.

Otherwise, India risks spending much of its conservation energy removing plants that are symptoms of a wider civilisational transformation that it has yet to confront.

(Suprabha Seshan lives and works at the Gurukula Botanical Sanctuary in Wayanad district, Kerala. suprabha.seshan@gmail.com)



A staff member rests as children play games at a RedClaw AI promotion booth set up outside a shopping mall in Beijing on March 28. AP

Expanding AI gets its biggest testing ground in China

Associated Press

On a recent weekday, around 50 people gathered outside the headquarters of a Chinese mobile Internet company, waiting to get help with installing an artificial intelligence (AI) assistant.

The scene in Beijing, China’s capital, was repeated for days at several events and was also seen in the southern technology hub Shenzhen in March, as engineers helped crowds trying to set up the popular AI “agent” OpenClaw on their laptops. “I’m worried about falling behind in technological developments,” said Sun Lei, a 41-year-old human resources manager at the Cheetah event. She said she hoped the tool might help her source and screen resumes across various recruitment platforms.

More than a year after OpenAI’s Chinese rival DeepSeek stunned the world with its advanced AI model, China has become a testing ground for mass use of AI tools. Chinese people and

More than 600 million people in China were using generative AI as of December 2025, a 142% increase from a year earlier

businesses have rapidly embraced AI for all sorts of things, from booking and planning travel, ordering food and hailing rides. Of its 1.4 billion population, more than 600 million were using generative AI as of December, a 142% increase from a year earlier, according to a report by the government-controlled China Internet Network Information Centre.

With the recent surge in the use of “agentic” AI like OpenClaw, the consumption of data by AI models has also risen. Measured in what computer scientists call tokens, or units of data such as part of a word, the weekly share used by Chinese AI models has recently surpassed U.S. models, according to OpenRouter, an AI “gateway platform” that tracks data and enforces security across different AI models. “The (AI) competition is clearly shifting from models to ecosystems,” said Lizzi Lee, a fellow at the Asia Society Policy Institute’s Center for China Analysis focused on economics and technology. “Chinese users are basically acting as real-time testers at scale.”

Chinese technology companies like Tencent, Alibaba and Baidu are also racing to commercialise AI. Tencent integrated OpenClaw into WeChat, China’s own “super-app” which is a messaging tool that can also be used to order food and make payments.

OpenClaw, originally created by Austrian software developer Peter Steinberger last year, won quick and enthusiastic use thanks to its ability to use various tools to complete complicated tasks. Zhao Yikang, a Chinese college student in Macao, uses OpenClaw in both his studies and daily life. “AI can understand things in a second,” Zhao said. “You just need to act as a commander and tell it what to do.”

Preparing to start a photo services business after graduation, Zhao asked AI to build a company website. Within 10 minutes, it had generated a fully functional site for less than 5 yuan (₹70).

Chinese companies increasingly are setting internal targets for boosting use of AI to improve efficiency, said Janet Tang, a partner & managing director focused on technology at consultancy AlixPartners.

There are “a lot of application scenarios,” said Wang Xiaogang, co-founder of the Chinese AI software company SenseTime and chairman of ACE Robotics. “The industry is developing very fast and the people, they are very open and they’re eager to try the AI in a lot of scenarios.”

For feedback and suggestions for ‘Science’, please write to science@thehindu.co.in with the subject ‘Daily page’

THE SCIENCE QUIZ

Chemistries of the surface and the bulk

Vasudevan Mukunth

QUESTION 1

The _____ of an atom is equal to the number of atoms bonded to it. In a clump of atoms, those on the surface will have a lower value than those in the bulk, since the surface offers fewer neighbouring atoms. Fill in the blank.

QUESTION 2

In a liquid, every atom or molecule is pulled equally in all directions by its neighbours. But on the surface, atoms/molecules have neighbours only on one ‘side’, so these particles exist in a state of constant stress. What is the resulting force called, which also allows some insects to walk on water?

QUESTION 3

It is slightly easier for molecules to escape

from smaller droplets. Called the Gibbs-Thomson effect, this is because the X of smaller droplets is higher. The effect is the reason ice cream left in the freezer becomes more grainy over time. Name X, which is a form of pressure.

QUESTION 4

Inside a metal, many electrons are not confined to their atoms but are free to flow around, like a fluid. If you disturb this fluid, it can slosh back and forth. These collective oscillations in the fluid are called what? The name comes from the technical term ‘plasma oscillation’.

QUESTION 5

It is possible for the surface of a material to start melting before the bulk does even if it is heated uniformly. This is because the material can cool by allowing what to form on its surface? It is the reason a gold nanoparticle melts far below the temperature at which a gold ring melts.



Visual: Name the brilliant effect on display here. A form of iridescence, it is entirely due to features on the surface of the oyster shell. BROCKEN INAGLORY (CC BY-SA)

Answers to May 5 quiz:

1. Drugs to block the final step in acid secretion – **Ans: Proton-pump inhibitors**
 2. Drugs that work by blocking the COX enzymes – **Ans: NSAIDs**
 3. WHO system that gives non-brand names to drugs – **Ans: International Nonproprietary Names (INN)**
 4. Expansion of ‘ARB’ – **Ans: Angiotensin II receptor blockers**
 5. Copy of a biologic made by another manufacturer – **Ans: Biosimilar**
- Visual: **Beta-lactam ring**

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Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Cost of EU plan to phase out Chinese tech for the bloc

432.83 in \$ billion. EU proposals to tighten cybersecurity by phasing out equipment from Chinese suppliers risk costing the bloc over \$400 billion in the next five years, China's Chamber of Commerce to the EU said. REUTERS

Teaching hospital doctors dismissed by A.P. government

51 Andhra Pradesh Health Minister Satya Kumar Yadav said the government has permanently dismissed 51 doctors serving under the Director of Medical Education over "unauthorised absence from duties". The move is part of a crackdown on negligence in the State's health care system. PTI

Amount to be spent by Musk on SpaceX AI chip project in Texas

55 in \$ billion. Elon Musk's SpaceX plans to invest at least \$55 billion to build semiconductor manufacturing facility in Texas, according to a public notice, producing chips for AI, robotics and data centres in space. He said the facility would be run jointly by his firm Tesla and his rocket company SpaceX. AFP

Saplings to be planted by Delhi Forest Dept. in the Central Ridge

1.5 in lakh. The Delhi Forest Department will launch a plantation project in the Central Ridge to transform around 10 acres of degraded forest land into a dense native forest ecosystem. They will plant nearly 1 lakh to 1.5 lakh saplings at a density of 3-5 saplings per square metre. PTI

Number of skeletal remains recovered from mass grave site

249 The number of skeletal remains recovered at the alleged mass grave site in Chemmani reached 249 during the third phase of excavation work ordered by a court, according to a human rights lawyer. PTI
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When does a CM cease to hold office?

Can a Governor remove a Chief Minister? What does 'pleasure of the Governor' mean? When is a floor test required? What happens after the Assembly's tenure ends? Can election results be challenged in court?

EXPLAINER

Aaratrika Bhaumik

The story so far:

A day after the Trinamool Congress lost the West Bengal elections to the BJP, party chairperson Mamata Banerjee on May 5 said she would not resign as Chief Minister, alleging that the verdict was the result of a "conspiracy" rather than the people's mandate. Addressing a press conference, Ms. Banerjee claimed the elections had not been conducted fairly and accused the BJP of misusing central forces to "forcibly capture" booths and influence the outcome. She added that the party would challenge the results and continue its political fight.

Can a Governor remove a CM?

Article 164(I) of the Constitution provides that "the Chief Minister shall be appointed by the Governor and the other Ministers shall be appointed by the Governor on the advice of the Chief Minister, and the Ministers shall hold office during the pleasure of the Governor." On a literal reading of the provision, therefore, the Governor appears to possess the authority to remove a CM from office. However, members of the Constituent Assembly had cautioned that such a provision could potentially lend itself to an arbitrary exercise of gubernatorial discretion.

Constituent Assembly member Mohammad Ismail Khan had moved an amendment to the provision (then Article 144 of the Draft Constitution) proposing that the phrase "during the pleasure" be replaced with the words "so long as they enjoy the confidence of the Legislative Assembly of the State." He contended that once the constitutional scheme envisaged the Governor as a nominee of the



A woman walks past banners of Mamata Banerjee, on Wednesday, in Kolkata. PTI

President, the Constitution ought to have made it explicit that the Council of Ministers would hold office not at the Governor's pleasure, but only so long as it continued to enjoy the confidence of the Legislative Assembly.

Addressing this concern, Dr. B. R. Ambedkar, Chairman of the Drafting Committee of the Constitution, affirmed that the Council of Ministers shall hold office only so long as it enjoys the confidence of the majority. "The reason why we have not so expressly stated it," he explained, "is because it has not been stated in that fashion or in those terms in any of the Constitutions which lay down a parliamentary system of government."

Over the years, the Supreme Court has also interpreted the Governor's powers as flowing primarily from the "aid and advice" of the Council of Ministers. In *A.G. Perarivalan v. State Through Superintendent of Police* (2022), the apex court observed that the "Governor" is "but a shorthand expression for the State government". While recognising the Governor as "the formal head and sole

repository of the executive power", the court held that the office is ordinarily bound by the aid and advice of the State's Council of Ministers.

When is a floor test required?

If a Governor asks a Chief Minister to step down and invites another candidate for the post while the tenure of the Legislative Assembly is still on, there has to be a floor test – a constitutional mechanism used to determine whether the executive enjoys the confidence of the legislature. Under this process, the Chief Minister must prove majority support in the House. Failure to do so requires the CM to resign.

If no party or coalition can form a stable government, President's Rule under Article 356 may be imposed as a measure of last resort.

What happens after the Assembly's tenure ends?

Article 172 of the Constitution deals with the duration of a State Legislative Assembly and stipulates that, "unless

sooner dissolved", an Assembly "shall continue for five years from the date appointed for its first meeting and no longer, and the expiration of the said period of five years shall operate as a dissolution of the Assembly."

According to the Election Commission, the current West Bengal Assembly commenced its term on May 8, 2021, and is set to expire on May 7. Thereafter, the Governor will have to initiate the process for constituting a new Assembly.

What happens next?

According to former Lok Sabha Secretary-General P.D.T. Achary, a formal resignation following defeat in an Assembly election is largely a matter of convention. "Even if Ms. Banerjee does not resign, it would make no material difference. The tenure of the present Assembly ends on May 7, and with its dissolution, she will automatically cease to hold office as Chief Minister," he said.

He, however, pointed out that an election petition may be filed before the Calcutta High Court within 45 days from the declaration of the results of the concerned candidate. Section 100 of the Representation of the People Act, 1951 enumerates the grounds on which the election of a candidate may be challenged and declared void, including corrupt practices by the candidate and non-compliance with statutory provisions by the returning officer, among other grounds. He noted that a writ petition may be maintainable where the challenge concerns the integrity of the electoral process itself, including allegations of arbitrary voter deletions during the special intensive revision of electoral rolls in West Bengal.

"Large-scale deletion of voters in an election constitutes a violation of fundamental rights and can therefore be challenged through a writ petition," he said.

THE GIST

Though Article 164 states that the Council of Ministers holds office "during the pleasure of the Governor", this is not absolute; in practice, a Chief Minister can continue only so long as they enjoy the confidence of the Legislative Assembly.

The majority of a Chief Minister is determined through a floor test in the House, and if they fail to prove support, they must resign.

What is Karnataka's new gig worker grievance system?

What gap does Karnataka's new system address? How will the welfare fee be used?

Shilpa Elizabeth

The story so far:

On May 1, 2026 – International Workers' Day – the Karnataka government announced the operationalisation of a specialised grievance redressal mechanism for platform-based gig workers in the State. Claimed to be the first government-backed grievance handling mechanism for gig workers in India, it allows workers to officially lodge complaints through the Integrated Public Grievance Redressal System (IPGRS), the State's centralised digital platform for addressing citizen grievances related to government schemes.

How does the system work?

Platform-based gig workers can now officially lodge grievances, including those related to pay, working conditions, and platform-specific disputes, via the IPGRS.

Under the Karnataka Platform-Based Gig Workers (Social Security and Welfare) Act, every aggregator platform must constitute an Internal Dispute Resolution Committee (IDRC). Grievances filed on

the IPGRS will be automatically routed to the respective platform's IDRC. Upon receiving a complaint, the IDRC is expected to attempt resolution within 15 working days, and is allowed up to 45 days to issue a final order. Any party aggrieved by the final decision can escalate the matter to the Karnataka Gig Workers Welfare Board within 30 days.

What concerns can a gig worker raise?

Gig workers can raise complaints related to suspension, blocking, or deactivation of accounts, termination from the platform, reduction or withholding of payments, unfair penalties, discrimination, unsafe working conditions, or other violations of rights guaranteed under the Act.

What gap does it address?

While many platforms have internal grievance redressal mechanisms, these systems exist outside a formal dispute resolution framework. As a result, gig workers have often reported a lack of resolution to their grievances. Many have complained that platforms quite often turn a blind eye to the workers' woes.

The Karnataka government's move seeks to bring more structure and transparency into the process and ensure legal recourse for these workers outside the formal economy. Gig workers can now officially lodge grievances through the portal, which will then be routed to the respective platform's IDRC. The government, as a central facilitator, will monitor the process.

Why is the mechanism being implemented now?

The Karnataka Platform-Based Gig Workers (Social Security and Welfare) Act, 2025, was officially notified in September 2025.

In March 2026, Karnataka became the first Indian State to notify the Rules to enact the law for gig workers. The grievance-redressal mechanism for gig workers in the State forms a crucial part of the Act. It is considered a major deterrent that would hinder arbitrary terminations or account deactivation of gig workers and address their concerns.

What are the other key developments related to the Act?

In January 2026, the Karnataka

Platform-Based Gig Workers Welfare Development Board was constituted to implement welfare measures.

Platforms have been mandated to furnish details of both the company and their gig workers – including name, age, phone number, Aadhaar number, UAN, and bank account details – to the Board. This data will be integrated into the Board's portal.

According to the government, so far, around 12 platforms/aggregators have provided details of 12 lakh active gig workers in the State.

However, given that several workers are associated with multiple platforms, the numbers could contain overlaps. This is expected to be sorted once the government comes up with unique IDs for each worker.

In February, the government announced that 1% of every transaction will be collected from aggregator platforms to provide social security benefits to platform-based gig workers.

What will the welfare fee be used for?

The welfare fee will go to the Karnataka Platform-Based Gig Workers' Fund to provide social security and welfare benefits to platform-based gig workers in the State.

According to government officials, schemes for gig workers, depending on the platform they work for, are being developed and will be put forward for deliberation at the next board meeting. The schemes being considered include life insurance, accidental benefit, disability benefit, medical benefit, maternity benefit, and old-age protection, depending on the nature of gig work.

THE GIST

Karnataka has operationalised a government-backed grievance redressal mechanism for platform-based gig workers, allowing them to lodge complaints through the IPGRS, which is routed to platform IDRCs for resolution.

The move aims to bring structure, transparency, and legal recourse to gig workers, addressing issues such as pay, working conditions, and arbitrary account deactivation.

